
A Report on the Growth and Development in Cameroon

Abstract

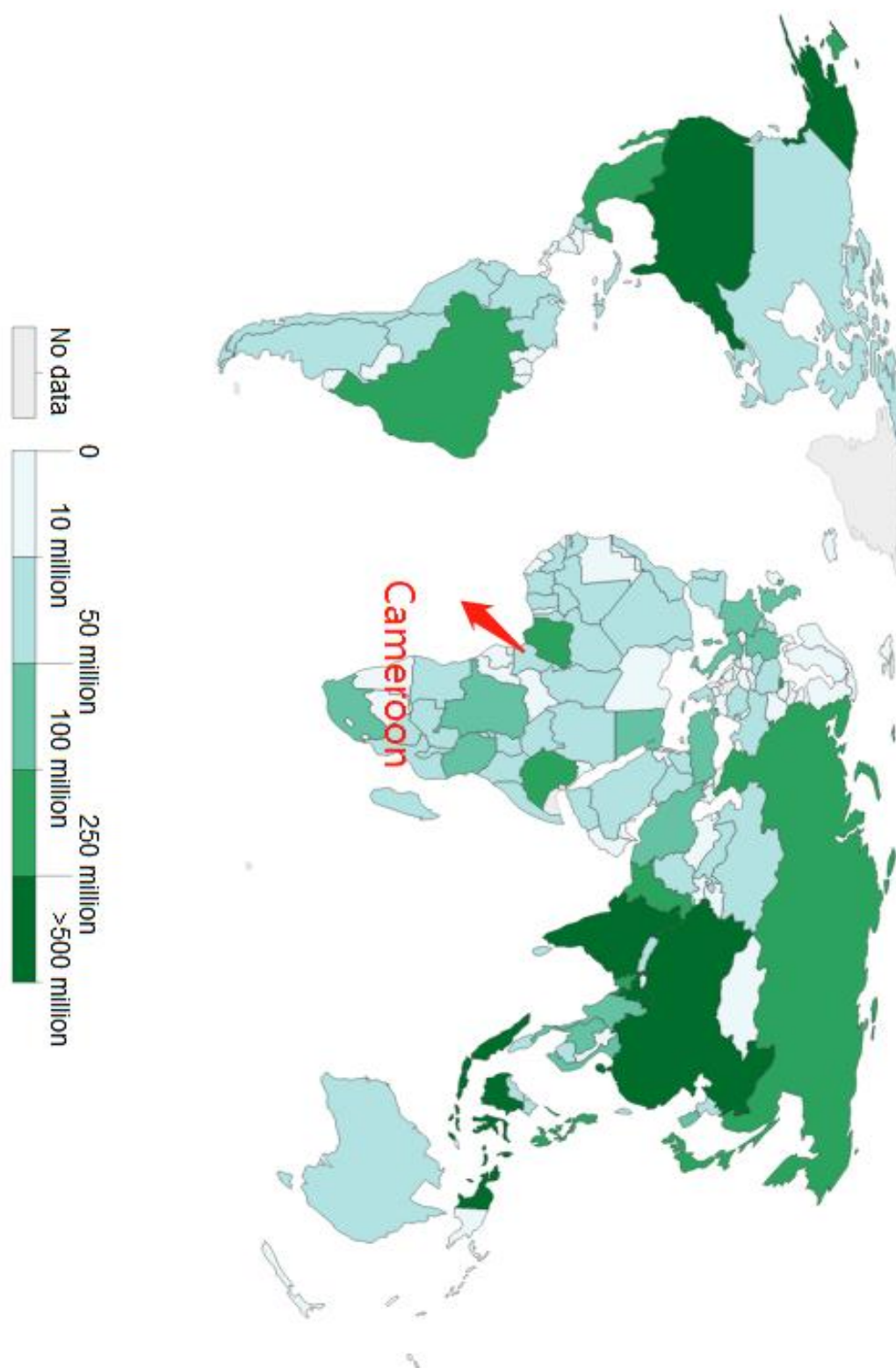
Located in central and western Africa, Cameroon is an underdeveloped country with a very low per capita GDP, which has been less than one-fifth of the world average even around 2008. In retrospect, it has undergone a severe economic crisis from 1987-1994. We examine its consequences on life expectancy in the case study, applying the synthetic control method (SC). The results suggest that there may be a causality between the economic crisis and the decline in the life expectancy. 15 years after the recession began, Cameroonian people may live more than 5 years shorter than they would live otherwise. Our results are significant at the 10 percent level. Besides, we analyze other dimensions of the country, such as population, equality, work & life, health, education, environment & energy, etc. Our report aims at providing an overall picture of the recent development in Cameroon while focusing on studying potential causes and effects of its economic downturn.

1. The Profile of Cameroon

Cameroon, officially the **Republic of Cameroon**, is a unitary republic in central and western Africa. Cameroon is bordered by Nigeria to the West. And its northeast and east sides are respectively linked to Chad and the Central African Republic. Its southern parts are adjacent to Equatorial Guinea, Gabon and the Republic of the Congo. Its coastline is close to the Gulf of Bonnie, which is part of the Gulf of Guinea and the Atlantic Ocean. Divided into 10 major provinces, Cameroon has 58 small provinces and 309 districts. The capital, Yaoundé, located in its central highlands, is the political and cultural center of Cameroon, and also the second largest city in the country after its “economic capital”, Douala. Plus, English and French are the official languages of Cameroon and the currency used is CFA francs. In 2016, the population is about 23.44 million, which is shown in Figure 1.1.

Cameroon is culturally and geographically diverse. Due to its geological and cultural diversity, Cameroon has the reputation of "African in miniature." There are mainly various families of Bantu languages and Pygmies in Cameroon. The main religions are primitive religions, Islam and Christianity. The country is known for its native style music, especially Marcos and Bikuts, as well as its successful national football team. Cameroon has a high degree of religious freedom and diversity and faith is practiced by many people. The main religion is Christianity. Although about two-thirds of the population adhere to Christianity, Islam is also an important religion, which one-fifth of the population believe in. Muslims are most concentrated in the north while Christians are mainly concentrated in the southern and western regions. On the other hand, Cameroon has a tropical climate. Its natural geographical features include beaches, deserts, mountains, rainforests, etc. Its highest peak, Mount Cameroon, is an active volcano in the southwest.

Figure 1.1 The population of Cameroon in 2016



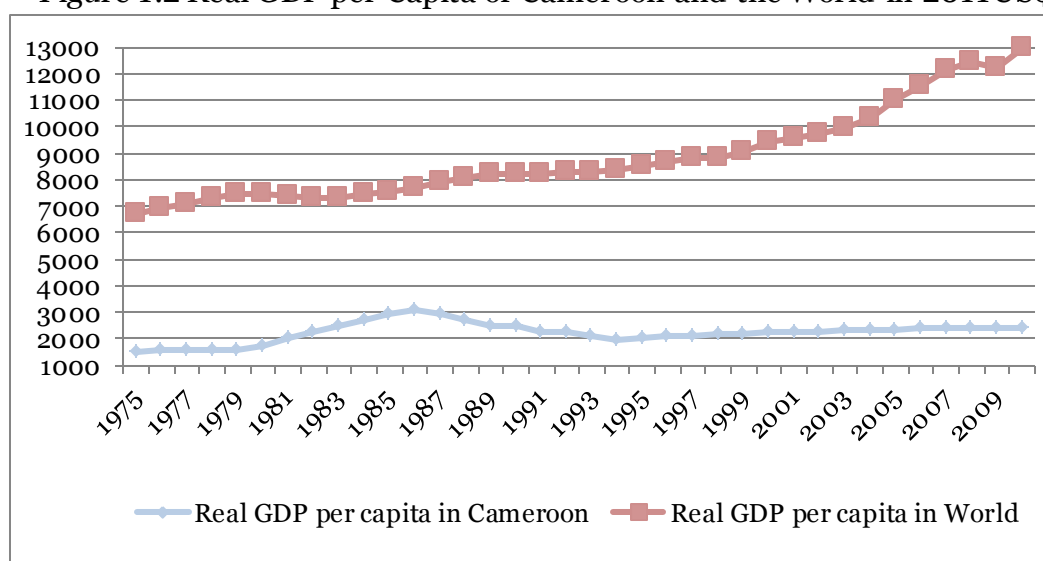
Cameroon has a variety of natural resources. There are many types of mineral resources in Cameroon, but the reserves are not very abundant. The main minerals identified in 2012 are: bauxite, uranium ore, gold, diamonds, copper, zinc, lead, manganese, molybdenum, nickel, Tungsten, etc. Oil is mainly distributed in the Gulf of Guinea, where they are oil reserves estimated at 103 million tons and natural gas reserves of about 110 billion cubic meters.

The forest is an extremely important natural resource in Cameroon. The country's forest area amounts to 22 million hectares, which accounts for about 47% of the country's land area.

Plus, its water resources are very abundant, accounting for 3% of the world's total water resources. Soil quality, climate and topography are suitable for the growth of various crops. The staples include cash crops, such as coffee, cocoa, and cotton, and grain crops, such as millet, sorghum, and corn. On top of that, the north has abundant grasslands and water sources. But animal husbandry in the area has not been developed until recently. Now herdsmen mainly raise cattle, sheep, pigs and other livestock. On the other hand, coasts, rivers and lake basins there all have a long history of fishing.

Cameroon's economic growth has been slow in recent years. From Figure 1.2, compared to the world average, the actual per capita GDP in Cameroon is actually very low. Even after 2008, it is less than one-fifth of the world average. From 1985-1995, the indicator dropped sharply from more than 3,000 to 2000, and it started to recover slowly after around 1995. We discover that Cameroon has experienced a period of economic crisis from 1987-1994, perhaps due to many factors, such as international economic conditions, drought, falling oil prices, corruption and ineffective government management. The analyses of the severe economic crisis and its consequences will be demonstrated later.

Figure 1.2 Real GDP per Capita of Cameroon and the World in 2011US\$



Cameroon has experienced colonial rule for a long period of time. The Portuguese explorers arrived on the coast in the 15th century and were named Rio dos Camarões (Shrimp River). They were called Cameroonians in English. Fulani soldiers established the Adamawa emirate in the northern part of the 19th century, and ethnic groups in the west and northwest established strong chiefs and believers. In 1884, Cameroon became a German colony and was known as Kamerun. After the First World War, the territories of French and British colonies were divided into the lands of the League of Nations. UPC's political parties advocated independence, but were declared illegal by France in the 1950s, leading to the Cameroon War of Independence between French and UPC's armed forces until early 1971. In 1960, the Cameroonian part under French jurisdiction became the republic under the educational rule of the independent Cameroonian president Ahmed Dorsey. Cameroon Southern British joined it in 1961 to form the Federal Republic of Cameroon. The alliance was abandoned in 1972. At the same time, it was renamed the United Republic of Cameroon and in 1984, the Republic of Cameroon. Before 2014, Cameroon's political and social stability was relatively high. This has made the development of agriculture, roads, railways and large oil and wood industries possible. A large number of Cameroonian people live as farmers. Since 1982, Paul Biya has served as president and has chaired the Cameroonian People's Democratic Movement. The country experienced tensions in English-speaking territories.

The stable situation in Cameroon has been destroyed by recent terrorist attacks. Cameroon's army was built after independence in 1960. The situation in Cameroon had been relatively stable until 2014. Frequent military conflicts in the northern part, like Boko Haram, have brought about the destruction of national security, since 2014. Disadvantages are more than insecurity itself. Poverty is accompanied by the increasing insecurity. Plus, developments in many aspects have been interrupted.

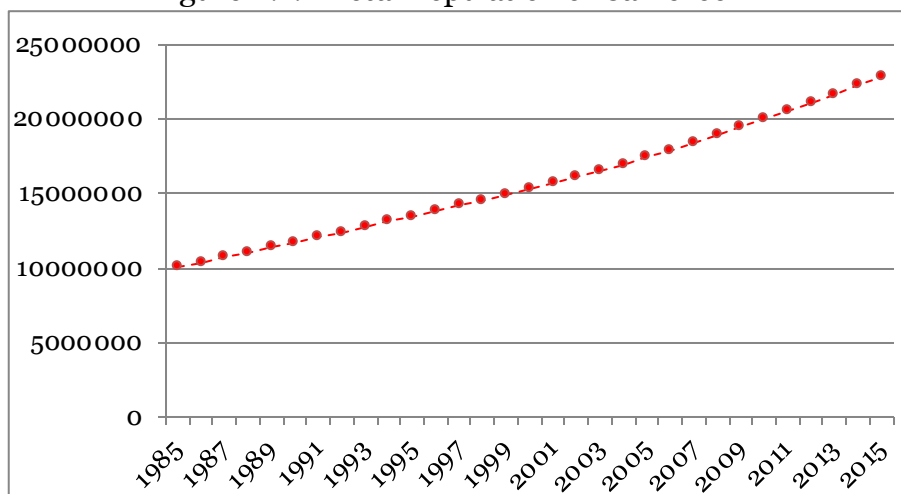
At the end of the section, we hope we have provided a basic introduction of Cameroon's background. In the next section, we will display more details of the country's development, in terms of population, health, education, environment and energy, public expenditure, military, democracy, etc.

2. Development Status

2.1 Population

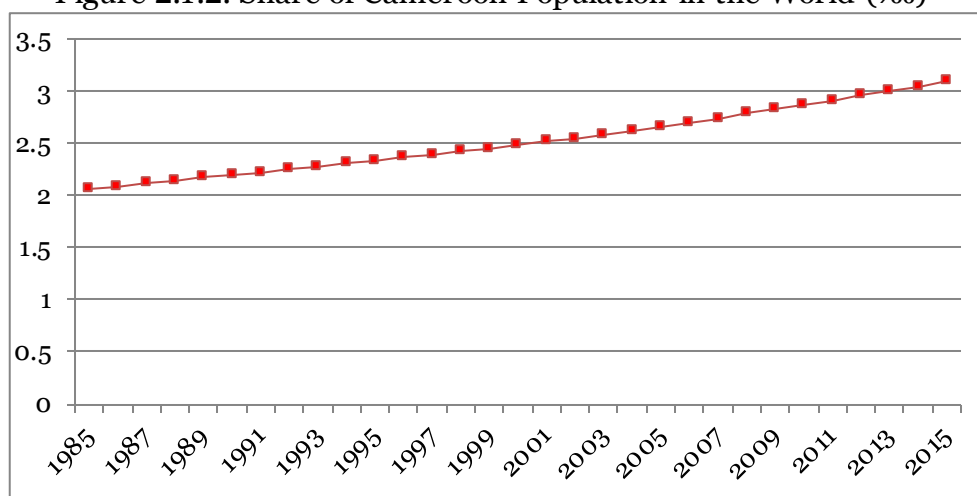
In 2015, population of the world reached about 7.4 billion people and that of Africa reached about 1.2 billion people. Specifically, there were nearly 23 million people in Cameroon in that year. As our study aims at the development of Cameroon, what does the population change during recent decades look like? In terms of population growth, what kind of problem faces residents there? In this chapter, we will examine those issues, beginning by analyzing the population change there.

Figure 2.1.1 Total Population of Cameroon



As is seen in Figure 2.1.1, from 1985-2015, total population of Cameroon more than doubled, which meant that the country underwent rapid population growth during that period. But, we are not sure how fast it was relative to global growth still. Was it faster than the global average? For this reason, we calculate the annual share of the nation's population in the world.

Figure 2.1.2. Share of Cameroon Population in the World (%)



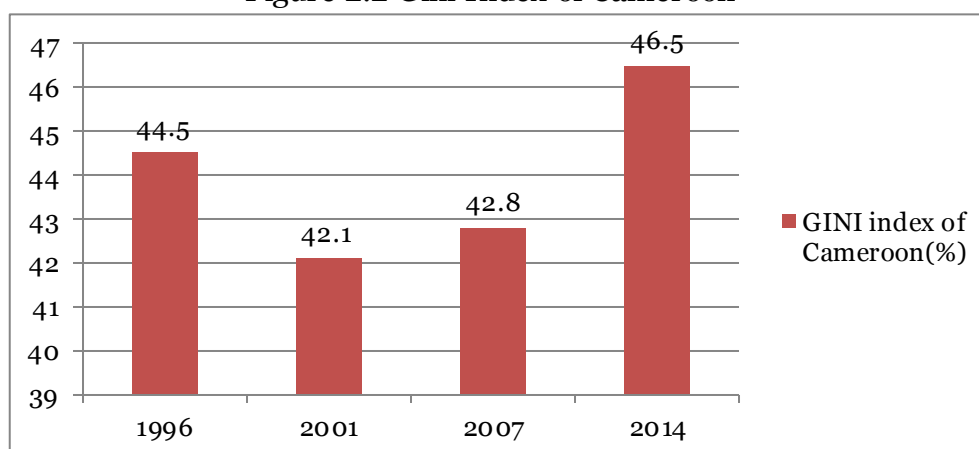
As is shown in Figure 2.1.2, from 1985 to 2015, the share of Cameroon population in the world rose from a little over 2% to more than 3%. Given the rapid population growth in the world in recent decades, we are surprised that Cameroon population have been increasing even faster than the world average. A very rapid population growth rate may bring about some undesirable problems, from resource allocation to unemployment and even to ecological issues. Therefore we may need to examine the consequences of potential overpopulation in Cameroon. But we will next look at other aspects to provide a quicker and better start for understanding its development.

2.2 Inequality

In 2015, the number of people living in extreme poverty was over 700 million. What is more terrible than poverty itself is the feeling of poverty. If you are feeling that you are poorer than others, income inequality is facing you. Inequality can give rise to great strikes, increased crimes and social instability, problems that could be hardly ignored by the government. If we want to do away with the inequality phenomenon, we should get to know how severe it is. As you may know, the Gini index, reflecting the income distribution of a population, is a good way to measure inequality. But examining the inequality is not so simple as you may expect. According to Max Roser and Esteban Ortiz-Ospina, the assumption that increasing top income inequality is a universal phenomenon is unwarranted. They show by data that income inequality in Europe and Japan was decreasing during the last century, although that in English-speaking countries rebounded to the initial high level at the end of the century. So did the governments in Europe and Japan succeed in finding a panacea for inequality or even for poverty? What kind of inequality pattern did Cameroon undergo in the past several decades? We will first set about researching its Gini index.

Unfortunately, the accessible information of Cameroon's inequality is so limited that we could not analyze it with sufficient and continuous data. However, sporadic data sets can still play a role, at least, in providing rough pictures of its severity. Figure 2.2 demonstrates that Cameroon might have followed a U-shape pattern of the Gini index in the last two decades. Should it be explained by expanding income gap? Or does it just mean that the equality has been relatively stable, remaining within a certain range? A lot of work is still needed. But we can now infer that the Gini index of Cameroon is likely to be at a 'high' level, which is to say that closing income gap is not an easy task to the local government.

Figure 2.2 Gini Index of Cameroon



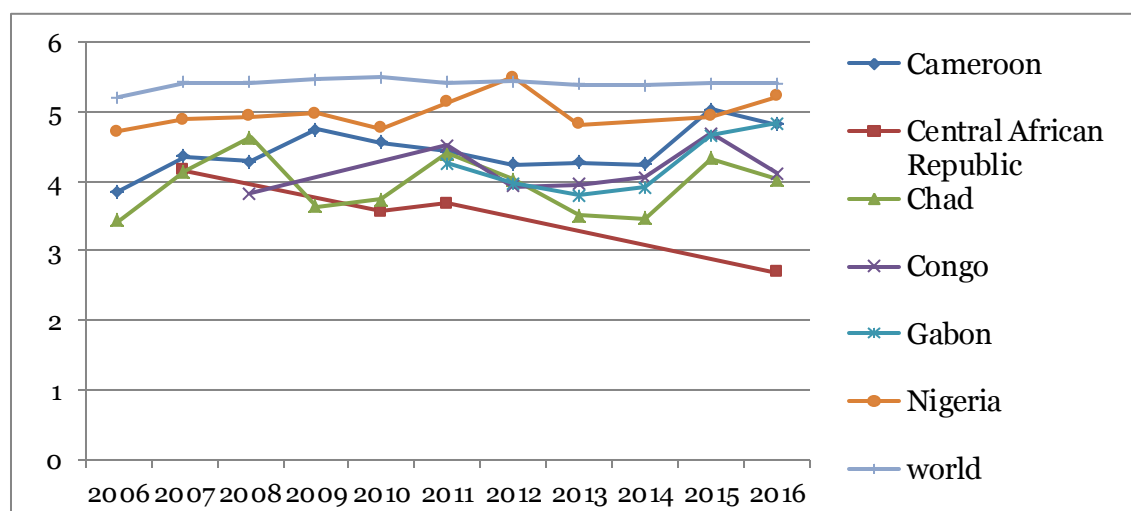
Notes: The Ginicoefficient is categorized into low ($0.2 < \text{Gini} \leq 0.3$), medium ($0.3 < \text{Gini} \leq 0.4$), high ($0.4 < \text{Gini} \leq 0.5$), and very high ($\text{Gini} > 0.5$)

2.3 Work & Life

2.3.1 Happiness and Life Satisfaction

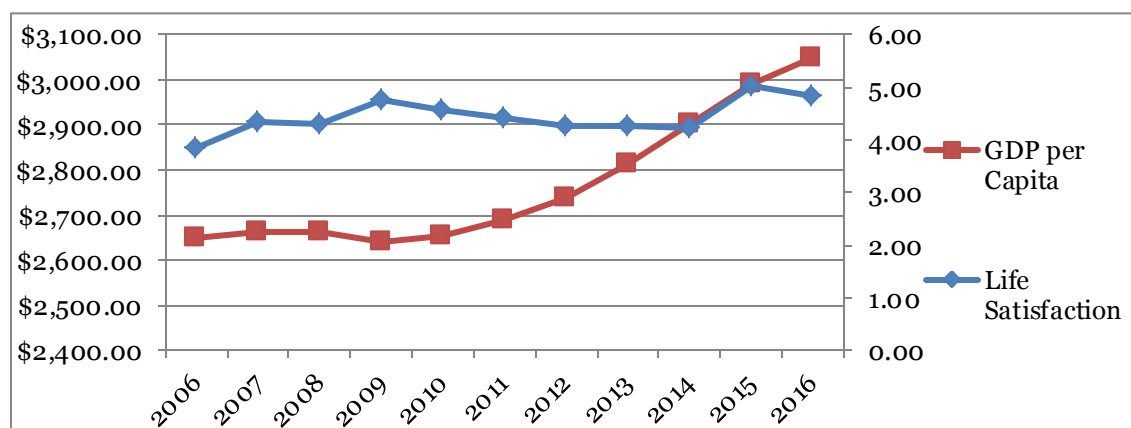
The World Happiness Report is a well-known source of cross-country data and research on self-reported life satisfaction. The main life evaluation question asked in the poll is: "Please imagine a ladder, with steps numbered from 0 at the bottom to 10 at the top. The top of the ladder represents the best possible life for you and the bottom of the ladder represents the worst possible life for you. On which step of the ladder would you say you personally feel you stand at this time?" So, what is the situation in Cameroon?

Figure 2.3.1.1 Self-reported Life Satisfaction



The figure 2.3.1.1 shows us the survey results of Cameroon compared with its neighbors and the whole world. We can see that from 2006-2016, the global growth had a relatively steady trend, while Cameroon's value grew from 4 to 5, a little lower than the world. In addition, compared with its neighbors, people in Cameroon have a higher outcome than others except Nigeria. So, what is the promotion of the improvement of the happiness index of the Cameroonian people?

Figure 2.3.1.2 GDP per Capita and Life Satisfaction in 2011

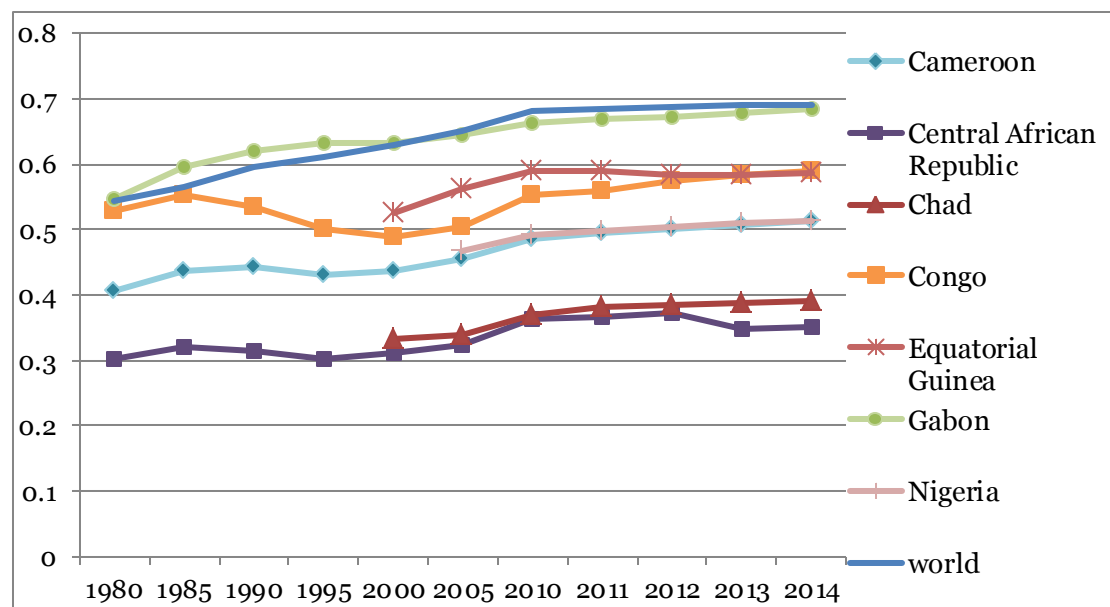


If we compare life satisfaction reports from around the world at any given point in time, we can see immediately that countries with higher average nation incomes tend to have higher average life satisfaction scores. As Figure 2.3.1.2 shows, although GDP per capital and life satisfaction scores of Cameroon are both increasing from 2006 to 2016, obviously the latter's speed is lower than that of GDP. But does it mean that they are irrelevant? Of course not. The logic that higher income can bring more happiness seems correct. Maybe there are some mechanisms affecting the correlation between income and life satisfaction.

2.3.2 HDI

The Human Development Index (HDI) is a composite statistic that measures key dimensions of human development: life expectancy, education and per capital income indicators. All data we use here are about New Human Development Index (NHDI).

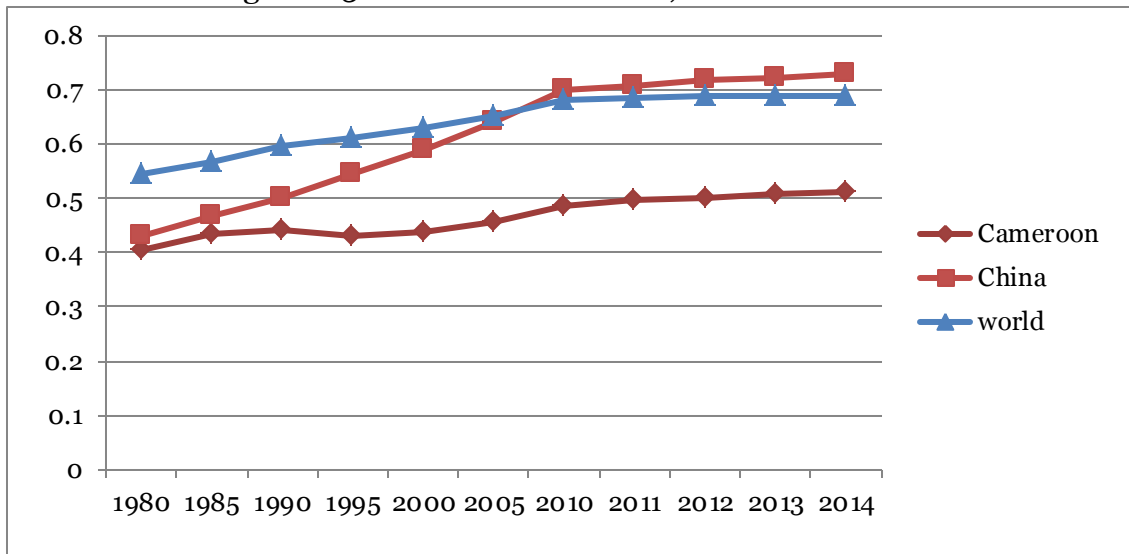
Figure 2.3.2.1 HDI of Cameroon and its Neighbors



In Figure 2.3.2.1, having increased from 0.4 to 0.5 during the last two decades, the index of Cameroon is still in a lower-middle level compared with its neighboring countries. Combined with last Figure 2.3.1.2, we can say that while from 2006-2014 GDP has increased nearly by 10%, the HDI has changed by 25%. We may therefore find that the development of HDI is accompanied by GDP growth. What's more, Figure 2.3.2.2 shows us the HDI of Cameroon, China and the world average. As we can see, although HDI of Cameroon and that of China were quite similar in 1980, which were both at around 0.4, China has experienced a larger growth rate than Cameroon since late-1980s. Around 2011, the HDI levels of the two countries have both flattened out. China's HDI reached a level little more than 0.7, even higher

than the world average, but that of Cameroon just reached 0.5, equivalent to the level of China in the early-1990s.

Figure 2.3.2.2 HDI of Cameroon, China and the world



2.3.3 Female Labor Force

The 20th century saw a radical increase in the number of women participating in labor markets across early-industrialized countries. The rising female labor force participation has been also one of the most remarkable economic developments of the last century. In this part, we will show Cameroon's situation from the perspective of female labor participation rate.

Figure 2.3.3 Proportion of Female Labor Force (%)

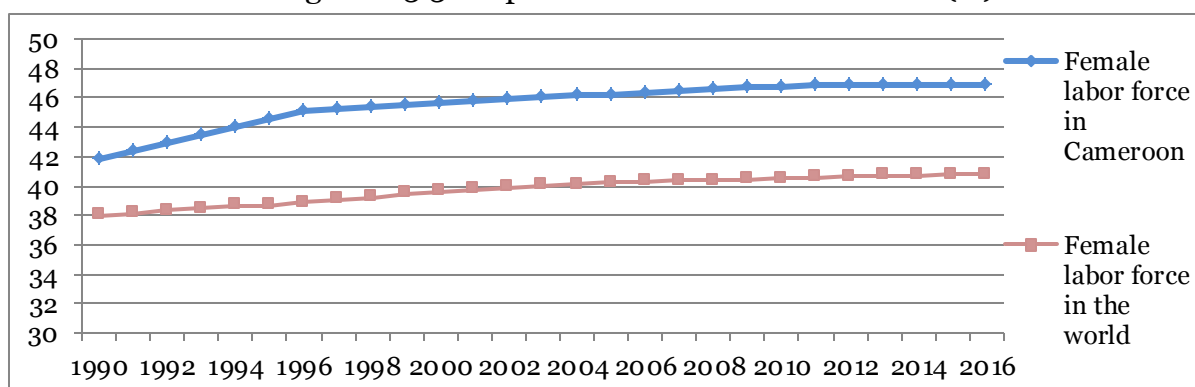
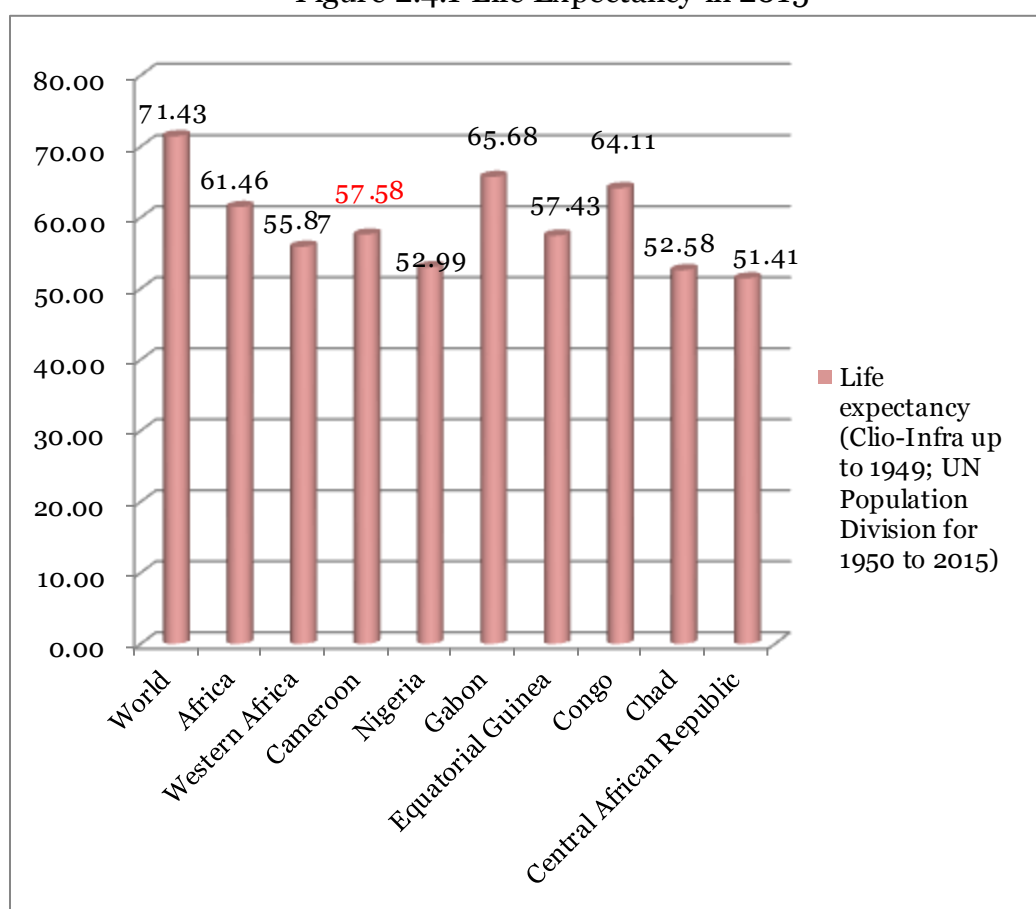


Figure 2.3.3 shows the proportion of female labor force in Cameroon and in the world, surprisingly, the female labor force participation rate in Cameroon is higher than the world average from 1990 to 2016. It is modestly increasing. We can guess that the increase in women's labor participation rate may reflect that the labor market's discrimination against women is decreasing, that women's average wages are rising, that women's family status and social status are gradually improving, and that even the education gap between men and women may be diminishing.

2.4 Health

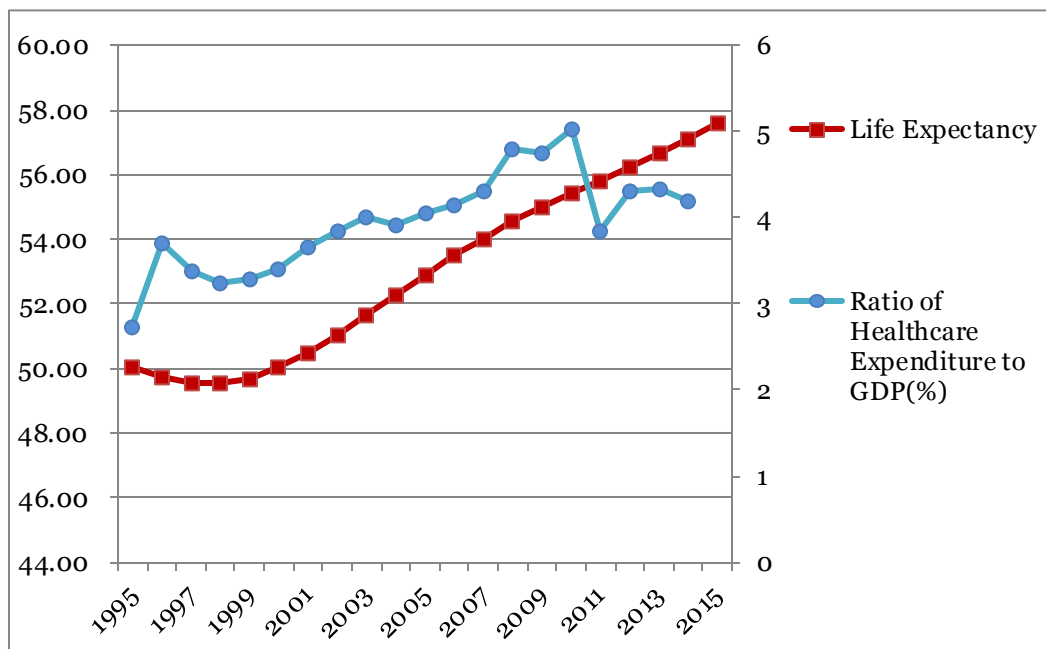
The World Health Organization (WHO) defines health as a state of complete mental, physical, and social well-being and not merely the absence of disease. So what does the health status of Cameroonians look like? We first take a look at life expectancy, an indicator thought to be a representative part of health. In 2015, average life expectancy in the globe was 71.43 years while that in Africa was 61.46 years. So in that year, could the average life expectancy of Cameroonians be higher than the world average, or even lower than the African average? We will show it in Figure 2.4.1.

Figure 2.4.1 Life Expectancy in 2015



As is shown in Figure 2.4.1, the average life expectancy of Cameroonians was 57.58 in 2015, even lower than the African average, let alone the world average. But as we can see, people in Cameroon were expected to live longer than those in some of its six neighboring countries, Nigeria, Equatorial Guinea, Chad, Central African Republic. On top of that, another good news is that its life expectancy was higher than that of western Africa. So its health status may be not as bad as we thought before. For further study, we examine its healthcare expenditure and life expectancy in a longer period.

Figure 2.4.2 Life Expectancy and Ratio of Healthcare Expenditure to GDP (%)



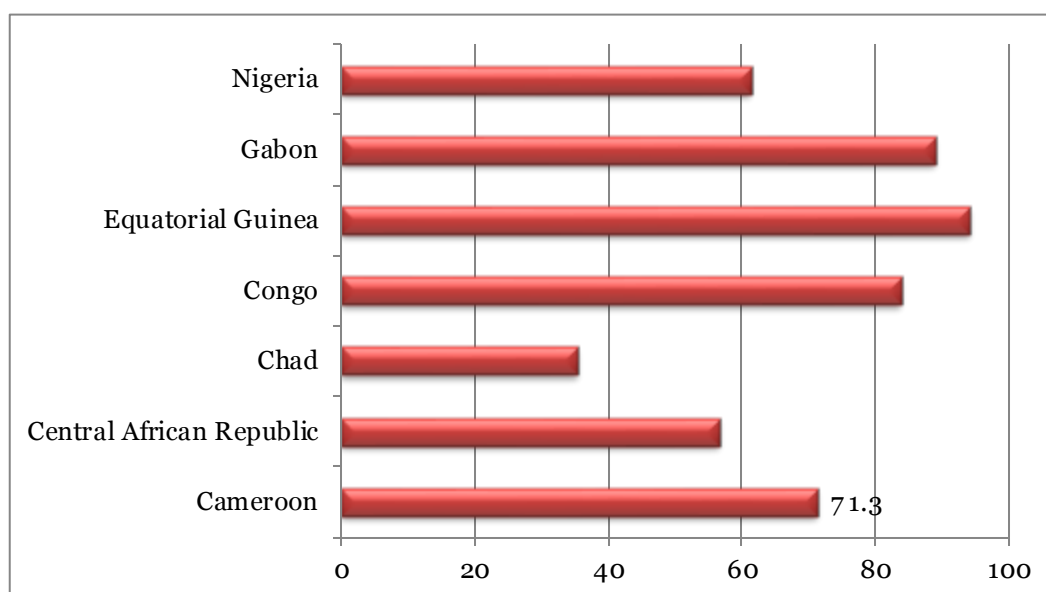
We can see in Figure 2.4.2 that life expectancy of Cameroonians increased gradually from nearly 50 years in 1995 to slightly below 58 years in 2015, meaning that the local government may have made a great progress in improving the longevity of the whole country. After dividing healthcare expenditure per capita by GDP per capita, we get the results of the ratio of healthcare expenditure to GDP in Cameroon. It turns out that in the last two decades, it has risen from below 3 percent to more than 4 percent.

2.5 Education

According to the latest data from 2011 or from the CIA Factbook, the average world literacy rate was about 85.77% in 2011, while that of Cameroon was only 71.3%, far below the world average. As we all know, African education is less sufficient than that of any other continent. To be fair, we will therefore compare the education in Cameroon with that in other African countries. Taking into account the geographical environment, climate differences and other factors, we would like to compare Cameroon with its neighboring countries: Nigeria, Chad, Central African Republic, Congo, Gabon and Equatorial Guinea. So, what does Cameroon's education look like compared with its neighboring countries?

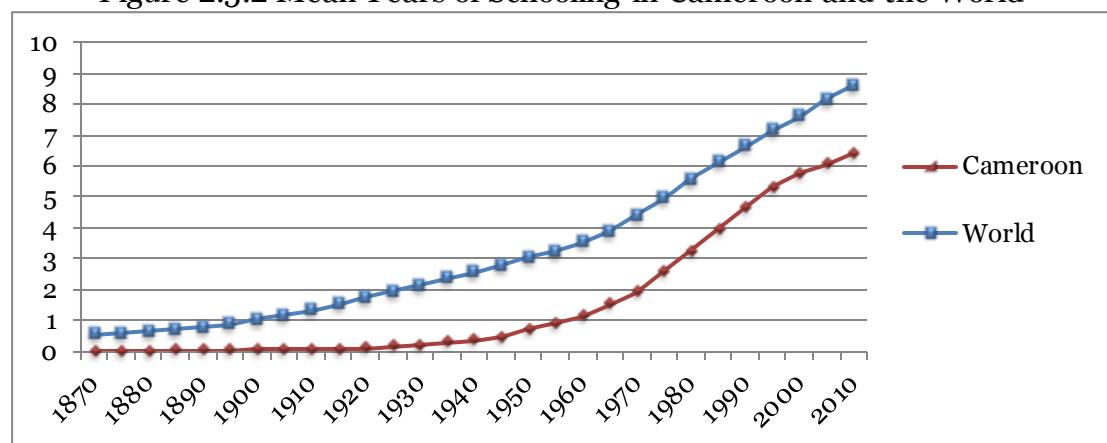
As Figure 2.5.1 shows, Cameroon is in the middle level compared with its neighbors, which means the average education level of Cameroon is not too bad in similar environment. However, literacy just means a basic skill, people who can read and write more than 15 are counted in. Therefore, how does the level of education in Cameroon develop at different stages - namely primary education, secondary education and tertiary education? Next we will briefly introduce the conditions of the three stages.

Figure 2.5.1 Literacy Rate of Cameroon and its neighbors in 2011 (%)



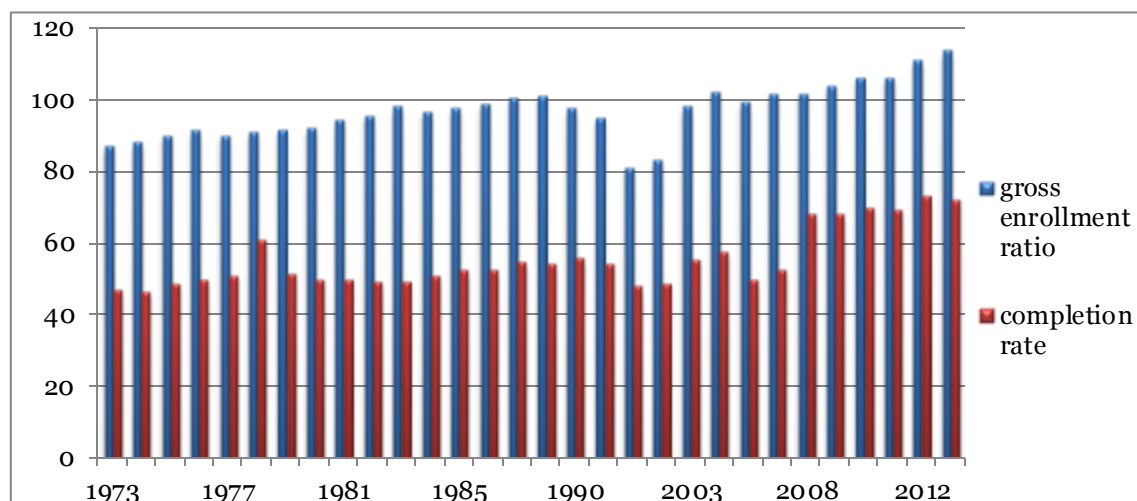
Before describing the education level, we would like to introduce two main indicators: Net Enrollment Ratio (NER) and Gross Enrollment Ratio (GER). The former one is the ratio of enrolled children in the official school age group to the total number of children in the official school age group, and the latter is the ratio of enrolled children of all ages to the total number of children in the official school age group.

Figure 2.5.2 Mean Years of Schooling in Cameroon and the World



It can be seen from Figure 2.5.2 that Cameroon's mean-year-of-education has increased from zero since 1910. However, although the level has increased, it is still at a lower level than the global level. From the figure we can also know that around 1960, Cameroon's data growth began to grow faster. Combining the previous history, this may be due to the fact that Cameroon successfully withdrew its control from France on January 1, 1960, with the assistance of the United Nations. It can be seen that the independence and autonomy of the country are very important to the educational level of a country.

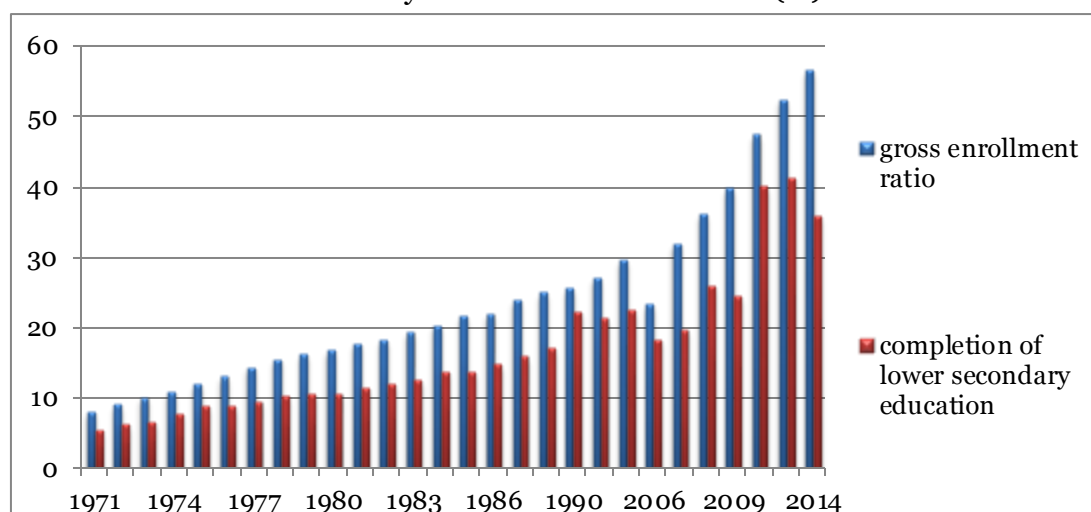
Figure 2.5.3 Gross Enrollment Ratio and Completion Rate of Primary Education in Cameroon (%)



From Figure 2.5.3, we can conclude that Cameroon's gross enrollment ratio and completion rate have generally risen slightly, except for slight fluctuations in 1998 and 2005.

Besides, Figure 2.5.4 shows the changes of Cameroon's GER of lower secondary education (Due to the lack of the whole secondary education, we would only analyze the lower secondary education, junior high school).

Figure 2.5.4 Gross Enrollment Ratio and Completion Rate of Lower Secondary Education in Cameroon (%)



The figure shows the gross enrollment ratio and completion rate of lower secondary education in Cameroon. In addition to the slight drop in 2006, the secondary education situation in Cameroon is improving, especially after the decline in 2006, and the growth rate has accelerated.

Figure 2.5.5 below shows the proportion of the population aged 15 and over who completed higher education. Compared with neighboring countries, Cameroon has a positive trend. The proportion of well-educated people is

increasing, except for one country, Gabon.

Figure 2.5.5 Share of Population with Completed Tertiary Education (%)

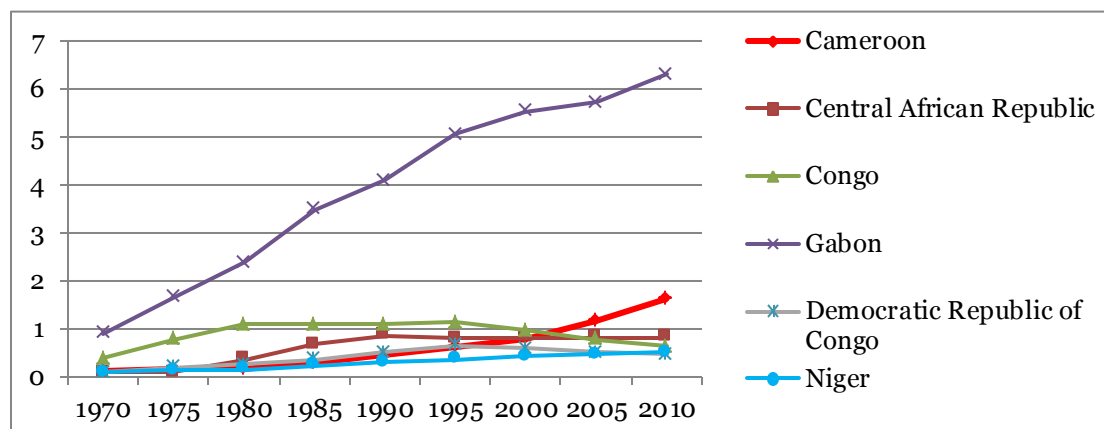
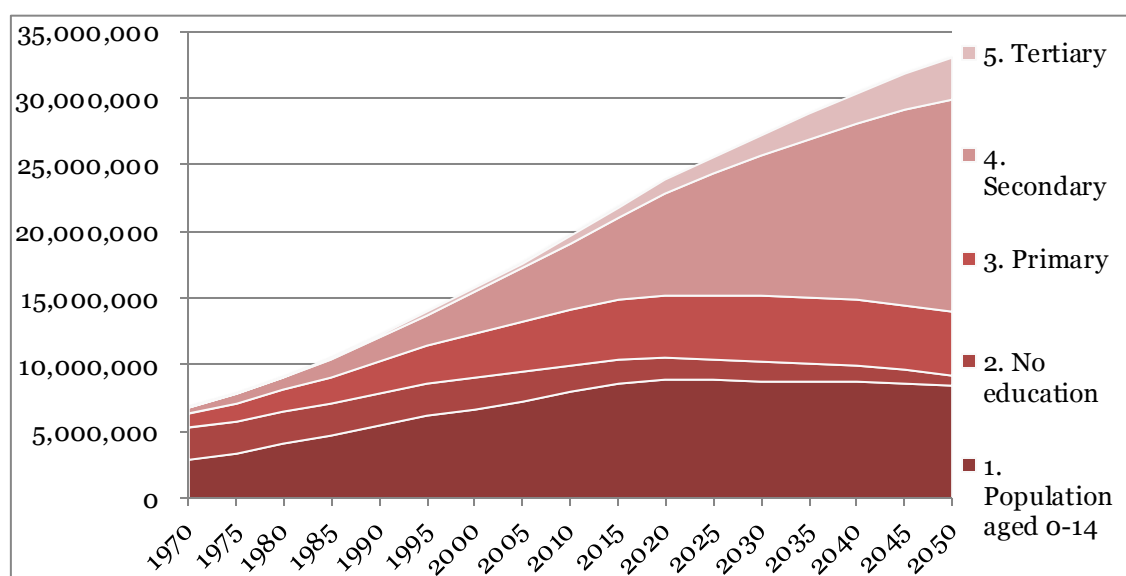


Figure 2.5.6 not only tells us the number of education levels in Cameroon at various stages of the past, but also predicts the development of education in the coming 30 years in accordance with its policies. As it has illustrated, up till now, the number of educated people in Cameroon has reached about 9 million, and by 2050 it is expected to reach 20 million. Those who would receive secondary education are the main target.

Figure 2.5.6 Cameroon: Population Breakdown by Highest Level of Education Achieved for Those Aged 15+



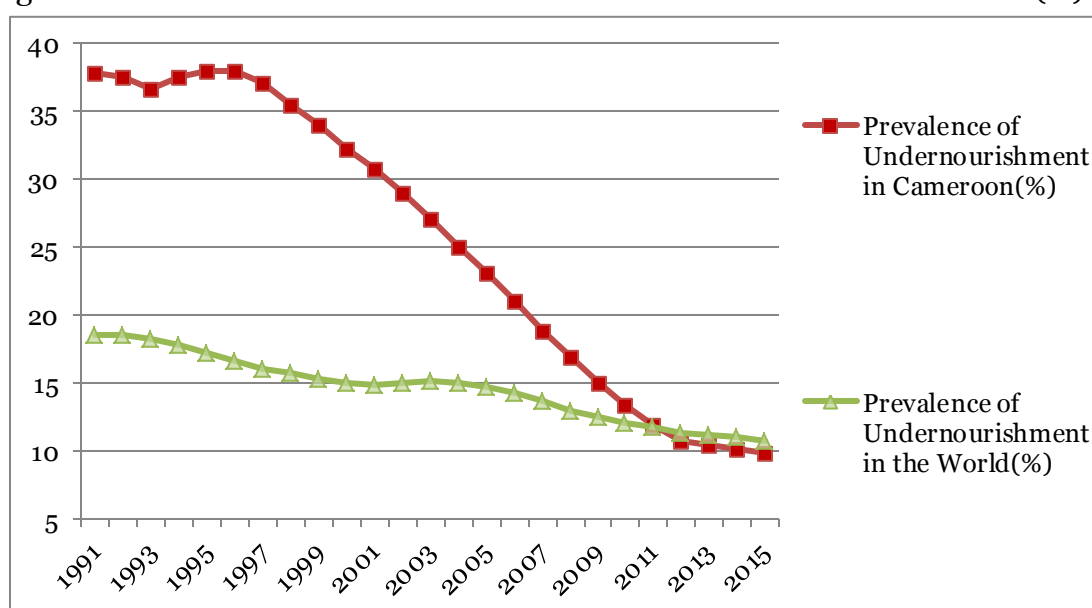
2.6 Food

The UN's Food and Agriculture Organization sees the prevalence of undernourishment, as a share of the population, as the main hunger indicator. It measures the share of the population which does not receive enough caloric

intake and therefore does not fulfill the minimum energy requirements. Does Africa have higher share of undernourished people? What about Cameroon? We will display the results in the following parts.

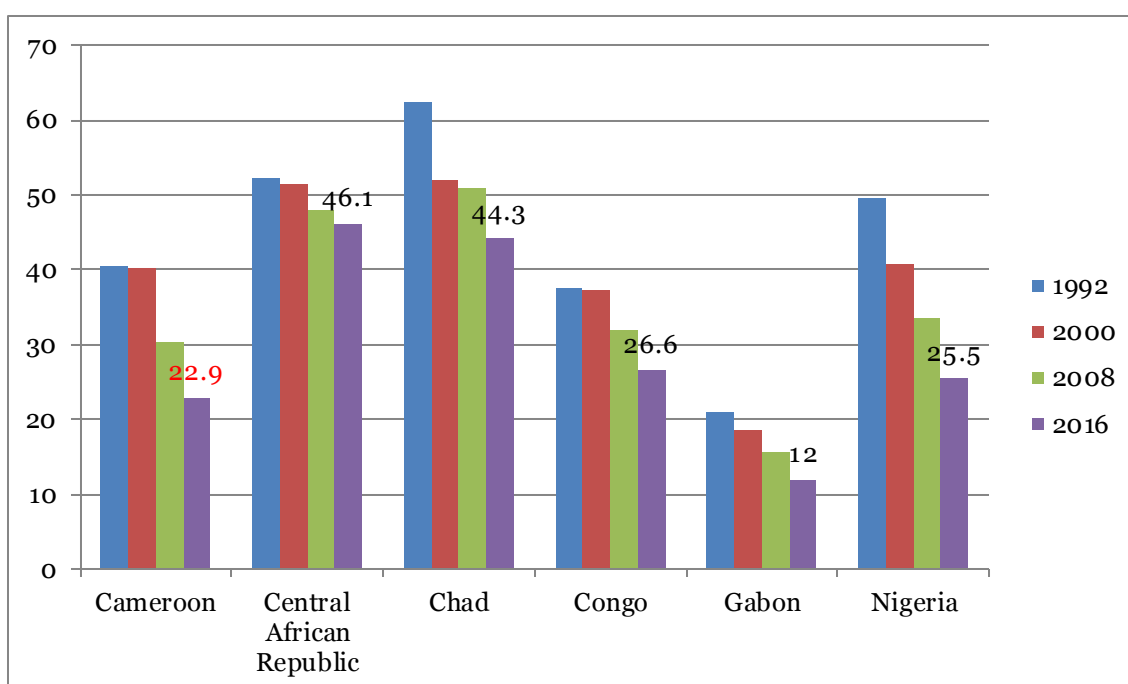
According to a survey by Max Roser and Hannah Ritchie, in 2015, prevalence of undernourishment in the world was 10.8%, and that of severe food insecurity in Africa reached up to 25.1%. As is shown in Figure 2.6.1, the difference in prevalence of undernourishment between the world average and the Cameroon has become markedly smaller and smaller. Back then, in the early 1990s, prevalence of undernourishment in Cameroon was 37.8 percent, nearly 20 percentage points higher than the world average. In comparison, by 2015, it dropped to 9.9 percent, even lower than the world average.

Figure 2.6.1 Prevalence of Undernourishment in Cameroon and the World (%)



But could we conclude so hastily that the country has got rid of food problems? Of course not. According to the International Food Policy Research Institute (IFPRI), Global Hunger Index (GHI) aims at measuring multidimensional nature of hunger of children under five years old. It combines proportions of undernourishment, child wasting (low weight for height), child stunting (low height for age) and child mortality into a single index score. The higher the score, the more severe the hunger prevalence is. It turns out that Cameroon and its neighboring countries except Equatorial Guinea have all experienced a decline in GHI in Figure 2.6.2, and that its index in 2016 is the second lowest among these countries, but even Gabon's GHI in 1992 is lower than Cameroon's index in 2016. In addition, given that the indices of some other developing countries, such as China, dropped to less than 10 in 2016, enhancing food availability and safety, especially for children under five in Cameroon, still has a long way to go. We hope Cameroon's GHI, at a 'serious' level now, will drop to 'moderate' or even 'low' level soon.

Figure 2.6.2 the GHI of Cameroon and its Neighbors except Equatorial Guinea



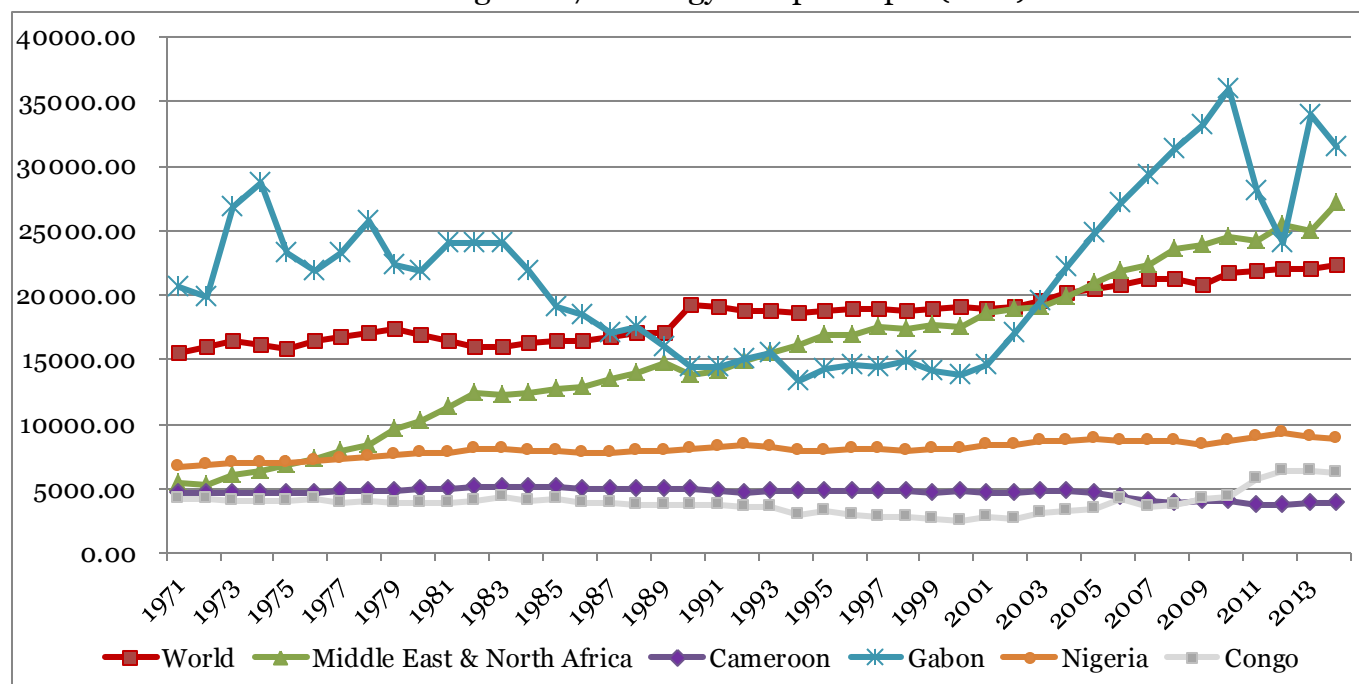
Notes: The index reflects scoring by country on a 100-point scale where 0 is the best score (no hunger) and 100 the worst. A score ≥ 50 is defined as 'extremely alarming'; 35-50 as 'alarming'; 20-35 as 'serious'; 10-20 as 'moderate' and <10 as 'low'.

2.7 Environment & Energy

When it comes to environmental issues in Cameroon, we will mainly talk about its energy production and resources. Since there are many different dimensions of energy consumption, such as natural gas, oil, electricity, and the total amount of energy consumed in each country varies according to the population, it may seem hard for us to find a single but perfect indicator which facilitates the comparison in different countries. But through a stroke of luck, energy use per capita is what we want and we have got enough data in terms of this indicator. It is widely believed that only when residents consume a large amount of energy can the consumption significantly promote social and economic benefits. Anyway, we will first examine the pattern of change in energy use per capita of each country.

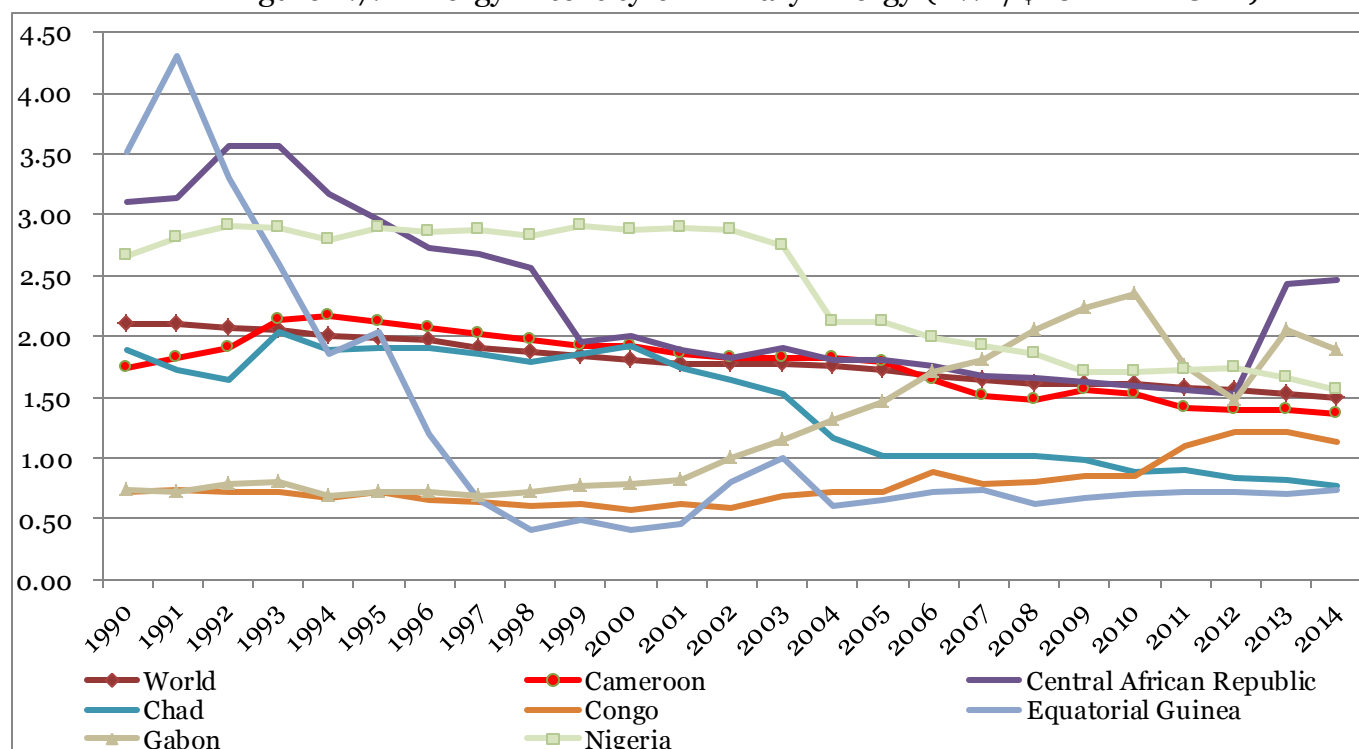
In Figure 2.7.1, energy use per capita in Cameroon has remained at around 5000 kWh since 1971, while the world average has risen from slightly above 15000 kWh to over 22000 kWh. Apparently, the growth of the former could not keep up with that of the latter. But even energy use per capita in Middle East and North Africa has increased constantly during this period. And we look at the indicator of some neighboring countries in Cameroon, which do not include Central African Republic and Chad due to the lack of data. Not unexpectedly, energy use per capita in Cameroon became the least among these countries after 2009. Perhaps Cameroonians could not afford energy consumption a lot for the reason that they always earned low salaries and had to satisfy a few needs of travel.

Figure 2.7.1 Energy Use per Capita(kWh)



However, lower energy use may mean higher efficiency of production. Thus, we examine this issue by analyzing energy intensity of economies. As we can see in Figure 2.7.2, Although the gulf between energy intensity in Cameroon and the world average remained narrow from 1990 to 2014, Cameroon was in the middle of the pack in energy intensity. Three of its six neighbors outweighed it. Therefore we believe that Cameroon should continue its efforts to improve production efficiency, without reducing energy use.

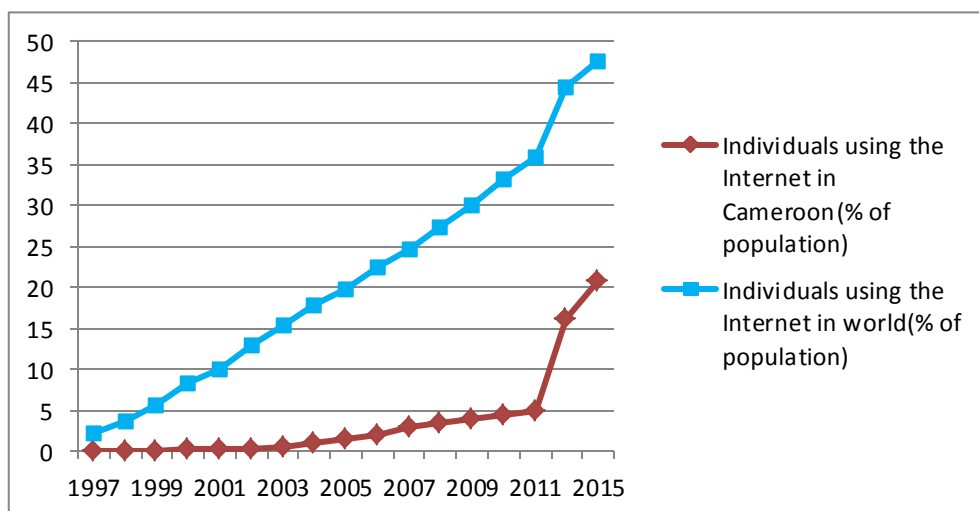
Figure 2.7.2 Energy Intensity of Primary Energy (kWh/\$2011 PPP GDP)



2.8 Internet

The internet has drastically changed the way we work, spend our leisure time and communicate with one another. It is estimated that the number of internet users worldwide is 3.2 billion in 2015. As we all know, the number of Internet users worldwide has skyrocketed since the birth of the World Wide Web. So, what is the condition in Cameroon in the context of the globe? The following chart plots the differences for us.

Figure 2.8 the Proportion of Individual Using the Internet in Cameroon



As Figure 2.8 shows, while the world's Internet is rapidly becoming popular, Cameroon's popularity is still very low. It is known that it has begun to show rapid growth only after 2011. With the popularity of the Internet, knowledge can spread faster and more widely. Can we draw any conclusions from the relationship between network penetration and education? We hope to study the recent relationship between the popularity of the Internet and the growth of education in the case of Cameroon. However, due to the data after 2011 are sporadic and limited, it is difficult for us to analyze the trend and draw warranted conclusions .

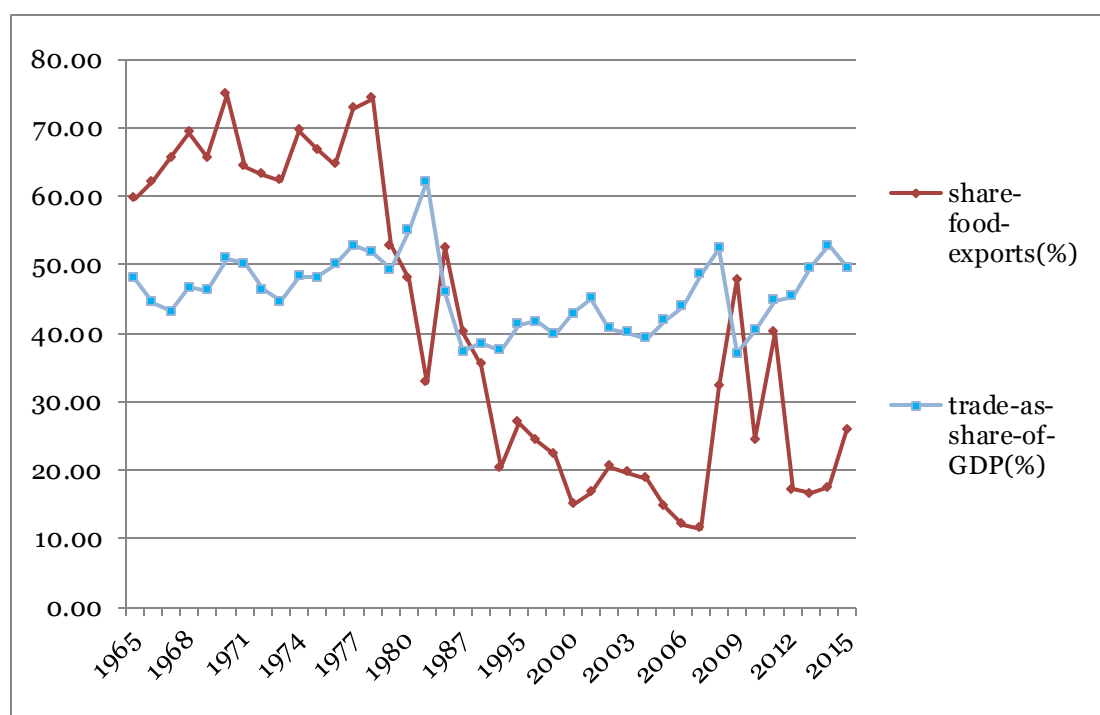
2.9 Global connection

Based on the available data we can obtain, we will analyze the following two aspects of Cameroon's global connection: international trade and tourism.

2.9.1 International trade

International trade has changed our world drastically over the last couple of centuries. The condition in Cameroon has also changed greatly during the latter of last century. As is shown in Figure 2.9.1, trade in GDP fluctuated between 40% and 60% all the time, while the proportion of food exports dropped sharply, next increased in 2008, then continued to fluctuate, showing a downward trend on the whole.

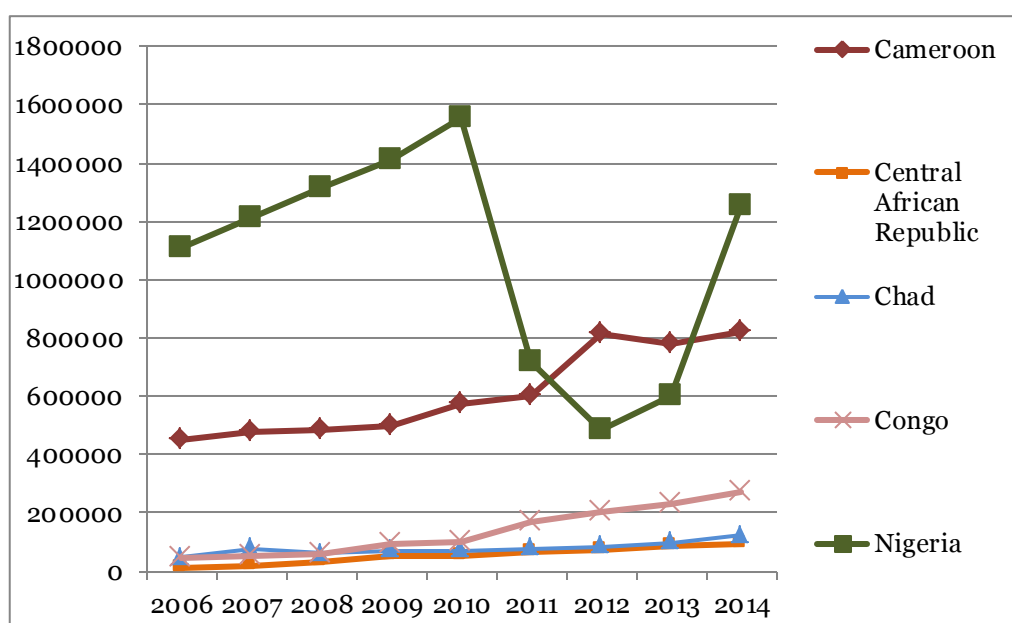
Figure 2.9.1 International Trade Ratio of Cameroon



2.9.2 Tourism

Figure 2.9.2 plots the tourist arrivals of Cameroon and its neighbors from 2006 to 2014. We can see arrivals to Cameroon increased gradually in the eight years, doubled in 2014 compared to 2006. Moreover, tourism development in Cameroon is in a good state of development, with a good development trend and occupying a high level in neighboring countries.

Figure 2.9.2 Number of Arrivals

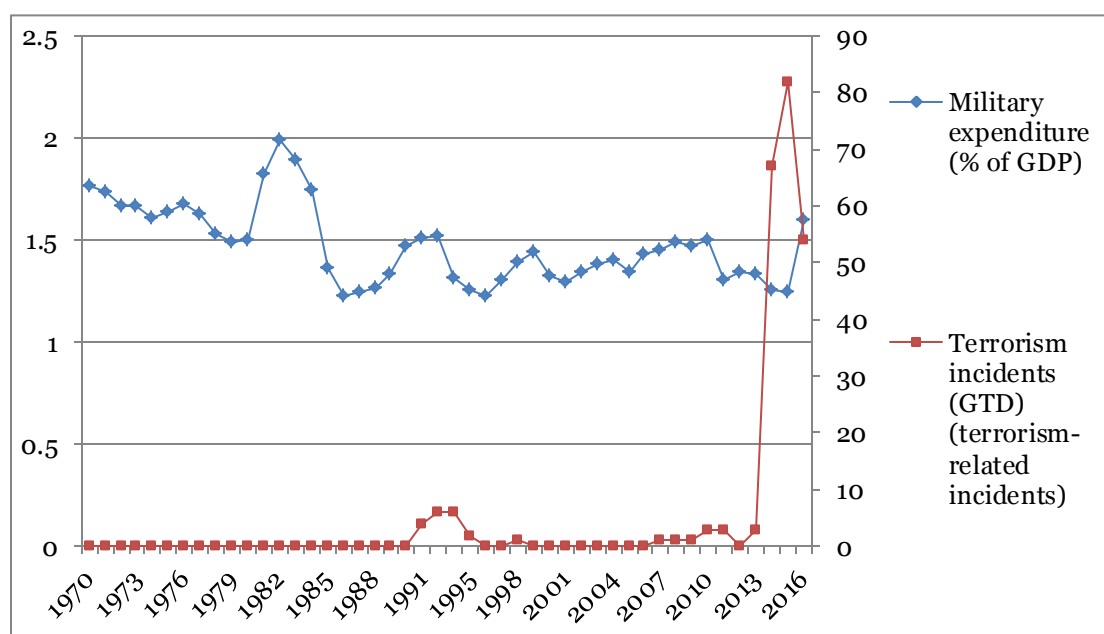


2.10 War & Peace

Terrorism is usually understood as the use or threat of violence to further a political cause. Here we will introduce an overview of the terrorist attacks and the proportion of military investment in GDP that Cameroon has experienced in the past 50 years.

As Figure 2.10 suggests, in addition to the small-scale terrorist attacks in about 1993 and 2011, the terrorist attack in 2015 was the most deadly and large number in Cameroon and continued for years (from 2013 to 2016). From the figure we can see that Cameroon's military investment as a percentage of GDP has been fluctuating around 1.5% (due to the lack of absolute data, we can only use the relative value-GDP ratio). However, due to the frequent terrorist attacks in recent years, the Cameroonian government may have to think more about strengthening the military and the national defense force.

Figure 2.10 Military Expenditure of GDP and Terrorism Incidents



2.11 Politics

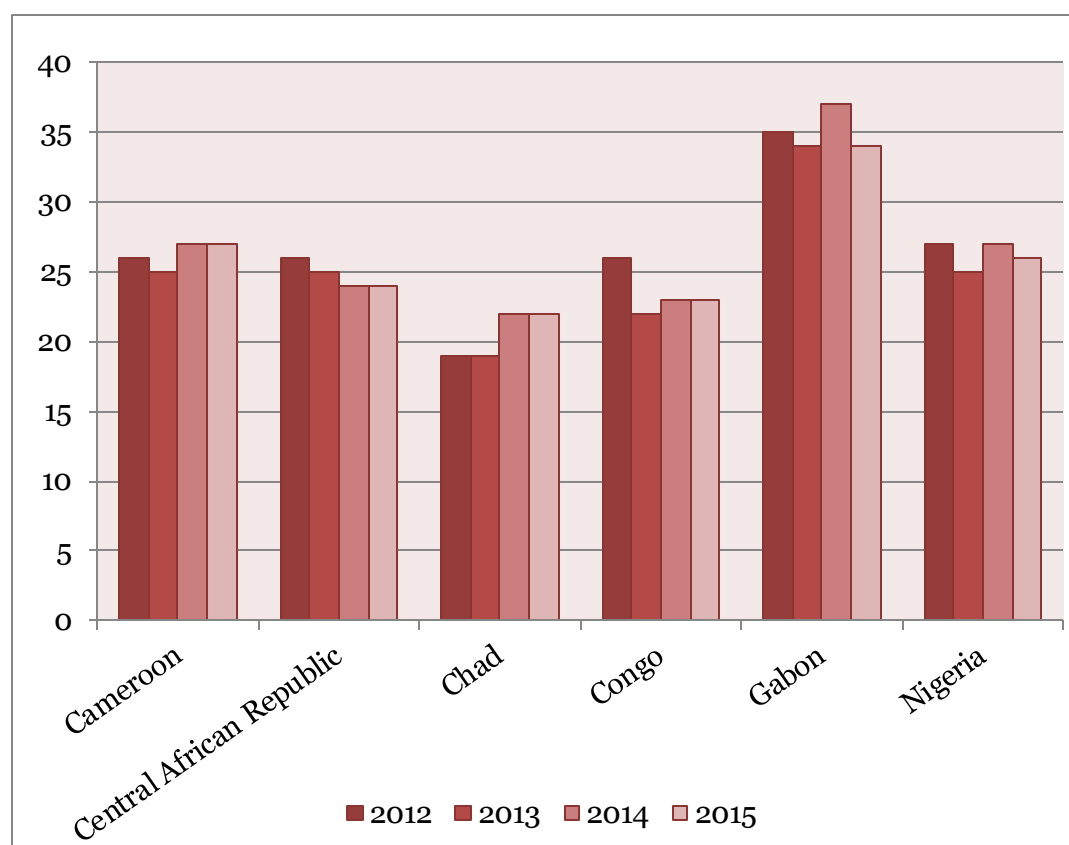
Based on the existing data, we will briefly introduce the current situation in Cameroon from the viewpoint of corruption and democracy.

The non-governmental organization Transparency International (TI) estimates a 'Corruption Perception Index', which is arguably the most widely used indicator of corruption worldwide. The Corruption Perception Index scores countries on a scale of 0-100, where 0 means that a country is perceived as highly corrupt and 100 means that a country is perceived as very clean.

As you can imagine, since the corruption index is an abstract concept, it

cannot be counted like the average schooling of education. Fortunately, although precise corruption measurement is difficult, there is a clear correlation between *perception* and *behavior*; so available corruption data does provide valuable information. If interpreted carefully, maybe it can both provide us something important for our research as well as contribute to the development of effective policies.

Figure 2.11.1 Corruption Perception Index(0-100)

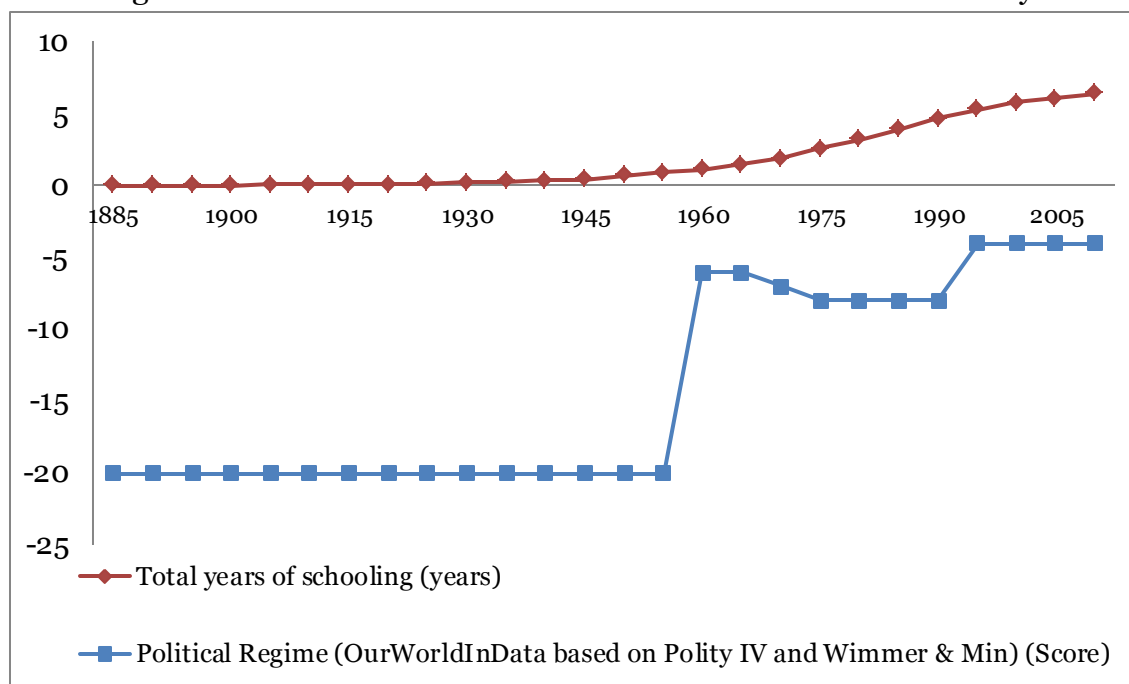


Notes: The Corruption Perception Index scores countries on a scale of 0-100, where 0 means that a country is perceived as highly corrupt and 100 means that a country is perceived as very clean. The indicator is representative of expert opinion, as it is constructed by taking the averages of various standardized expert surveys, including those from the Bertelsmann Foundation, the World Economic Forum, the World Bank.

Figure 2.11.1 provides us the Corruption Perception Index from 2012 to 2015 in Cameroon and its main neighbors. Although Cameroon's corruption perception index is in the middle among its neighbors, its absolute value is still very low, which means that corruption in Cameroon is not optimistic. If officials want to promote the development of the country, the governance and reform of government agencies are indispensable. Next, let us have a look at the condition of democracy.

A democracy is a political system with institutions that allows citizens to express their political preferences, provides constraints on the power of the executive. It is therefore a guarantee of civil liberties. We will mainly analyze the correlation between education and democracy.

Figure 2.11.2 the Correlation between Education and Democracy



Notes: The Polity IV score classifies the type of political regime for each country on a range from -10 (full autocracy) to +10 (full democracy). Regimes that fall into the middle of this spectrum, ranging from -5 to 5, are called anocracies. Plus, a score < -10 means a country in the colonial period.

From Figure 2.11.2, we can easily see that since the education level in Cameroon has improved in 2000, its democratic score has gradually increased from -20 to -4, which indicates the significance of education to the government.

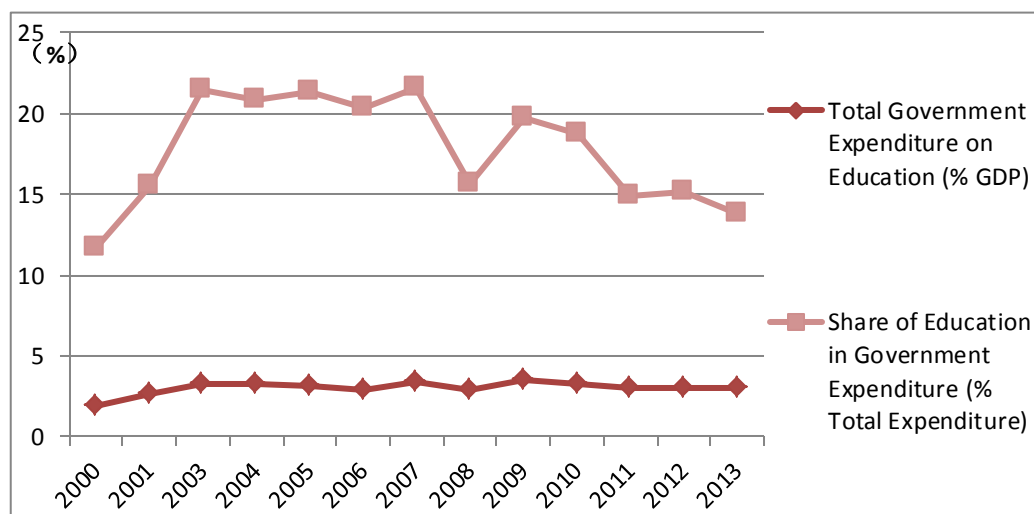
Cameroon is considered corruption prevalent at all levels of government. In 1997, Cameroon established anti-corruption bureaus in 29 ministries, but only 25% of them were operational. In 2012, Transparency International listed Cameroon as the 144th out of 176 countries. On January 18, 2006, Biya launched the anti-corruption campaign under the guidance of the National Anti-Corruption Observatory. There are still several areas of high corruption risk in the country, such as customs, public health authorities and public procurement sectors, etc.

2.12 Public Sector

In this section, we will have a short introduction to the relationship between Cameroon's education, taxation, and government expenditure and its share of GDP.

Public spending enables governments to produce and purchase goods and services, in order to fulfil their objectives – such as the provision of public goods or the redistribution of resources. The proportion of spending on education shows that the government attaches importance to education, and can also explain the level of development of the country to some extent.

Figure 2.12.1 Total Government Expenditure on Education (% of GDP) and Share of Education in Government Expenditure (% of Total Expenditure)



From Figure 2.12.1, we can see that in the total government expenditure, the share of education fluctuates greatly, showing a trend of increasing first and then decreasing. However, the government education expenditure as a percentage of GDP is relatively stable and remains at about 2.5%. What about the Cameroonian government's emphasis on education? If we have the opportunity, we will conduct research and analysis from other aspects. Let's have a look at analysis about the tax then.

The proportion of fiscal revenue to GDP, also known as fiscal dependency, is an important indicator of the quality of economic operations in a country or region. The higher the ratio of government revenue to GDP, the more adequate the state (or local) financial resources.

Figure 2.12.2 Total Tax Revenues of GDP (%)

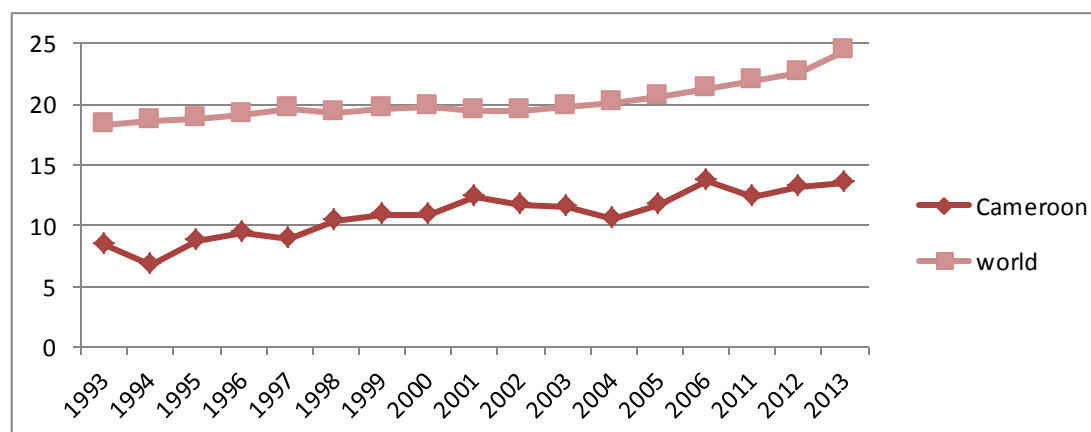


Figure 2.12.2 shows us the change in financial dependency between Cameroon and the world average from 1993 to 2013. Although Cameroon is far below the world average, it still shows a continuous and slowly increasing trend, which is consistent with the gradual increase in its national income.

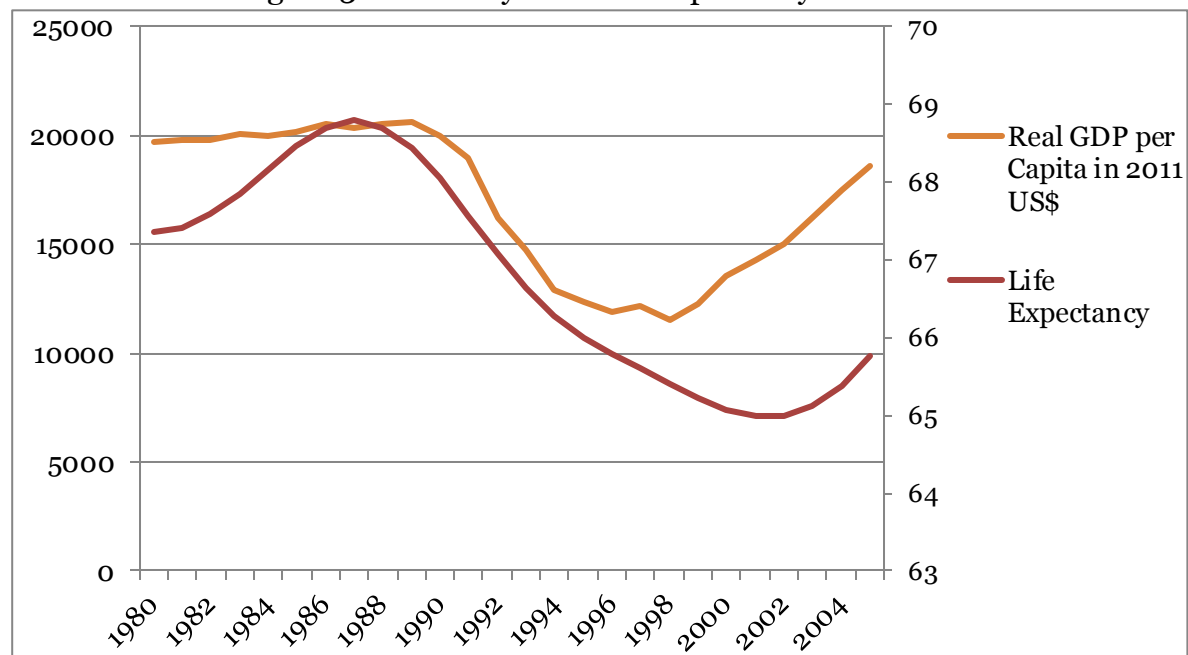
3. A case study: Cameroon's Economic Crisis and Life

Expectancy

It is widely believed that the economic transition of the former Soviet Union has contributed to the chronic decline of average life span in Russia. In this section, we will not discuss what have caused its economic transformation, as many articles have done. We will start by reviewing the economic transition of Soviet and try to figure out whether there is a correlation between a country's economic development and its life expectancy. Afterwards, we will focus on examining the consequences of the economic crisis of Cameroon, a downturn in its economy from the mid-1980s to the early 2000s.

To begin with, we will review the correlation between Soviet's economy and its life expectancy from 1980-2005, which is shown in Figure 3.1. Obviously, since 1990, real GDP per capita and life expectancy in what we call Russia now have experienced a drastic decline for more than 8 years. As you can see, the decline in its life expectancy has lasted much longer, meaning that average life span has suffered more from the economic transition. So could we firmly state that if a country improves its economy, its people will live significantly longer? We should go through this statement with discretion.

Figure 3.1 Economy and Life Expectancy of Russia



Simply put, we collect the relevant data of 161 countries or regions over 26 years and estimate the effect of GDP per capita on life expectancy in the following regression:

$$(1) Life_{it} = \alpha_0 + \alpha_1 GDP_{it} + \alpha_2 X_{it} + \varepsilon_{it} ,$$

where $Life_{it}$ is a measure of country i 's life expectancy in year t , and GDP_{it}

is a measure of the country's per capita GDP. The vector X_{it} includes many factors that may affect life expectancy and therefore need to be controlled.

Now we will look at the results. All columns of Table 3.1 show that GDP per capita and life expectancy are weakly correlated, no matter which factor we are controlling for. On the other hand, it can be easily seen that the increase of child mortality rate will significantly lead to the decline of life expectancy. This is not surprising since life expectancy is calculated on the basis of mortality rates in all age groups. However, we are still surprised that the increase of GDP per capita likely contributes little to the improvement of life expectancy.

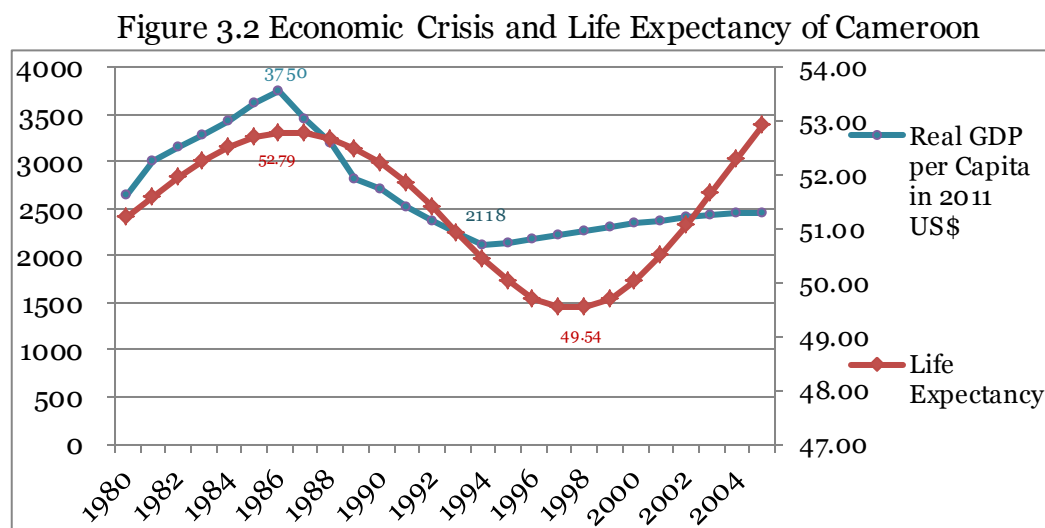
Table 3.1 The Effect of GDP per Capita on Life Expectancy

	Life Expectancy		
	(1)	(2)	(3)
GDP per Capita	0.0000149 (0.0000127)	0.0000217 (0.0000208)	(0.000019) (0.000017)
Control Variables:			
Child Mortality Rate		-0.9716073 (0.0824233)***	-0.9753563 (0.0991375)***
Fertility Rate Children per Woman		0.0287142 (0.4002183)	0.0442017 (0.4276962)
Polio Cases		-0.0000227 (0.0000161)	-0.0000147 (0.0000168)
Estimated Prevalence of Daily Smoking		-0.1439461 (0.0414228)***	-0.1380128 (0.0487084)***
Political Regime type Score			-0.1018394 (0.0360808)***
Human Rights Protection Score			0.6973268 (0.2543083)***
Year Fixed Effects	Yes	Yes	Yes
Country Fixed Effects	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	4186	3324	3039
R-squared	0.0546	0.8707	0.8651

Notes: Observations are countries or regions across 26-year time intervals from 1980-2005. The original sample includes 196 countries or regions. * Significant at the 10 percent level. ** Significant at the 5 percent level. *** Significant at the 1 percent level.

So now we may guess that although life expectancy cannot benefit from the economic growth directly, economic decline may give rise to strikingly decreasing life expectancy, the way Russia supposedly did. Let us return once again to Cameroon. Many researchers define the economic crisis of Cameroon as a period from the mid-1980s to the early 2000s. We believe that they do so because its negative impacts on many aspects of the country lasted longer

than the period when the economy was just in a downward trend, as is shown in Figure 3.2. As you can see, the decline in GDP per capita and life expectancy both began in 1986. However, after the country got out of the economic falling trend, its life expectancy still continued to drop for a while. It did not rise until 1998. But could we say that it returned to the normal upward trend right after 1998? Of course, we could not say that.



Could we then estimate the gap between real life expectancy and what it would have been in the absence of the economic crisis? It seems like a tough task to us. Fortunately, Abadie and his collaborators once developed a method called synthetic control method(SC), which aimed at facilitating analyses of comparative case studies. Thanks to their efforts, we could not only crack the problem of measuring the gap but even avoid the traditional limitations, especially when we apply difference-in-differences method(DID). In other words, we could measure the gap more accurately. Before we apply SC, it is necessary that we should briefly introduce its principles and advantages compared to DID.

First, when we conduct comparative case studies, we usually cannot choose comparison units objectively. We may just use neighbors of treatment group as a comparison group. This is a common case when we use DID. But even if our research satisfies parallel trend assumption, we cannot tell whether the comparison group we have chosen is the optimal one. Perhaps there exists another comparison group that also meets the requirement of the assumption and has more similar important characteristics or dimensions before the treatment. This means that DID may not help us choose the optimal comparison group and therefore we are less likely to get very precise, unbiased results. However, SC addresses the shortcomings when we are using DID to conduct case studies. It constructs optimal comparison groups based on data-driven procedures, which are said to force researchers to find out the most like group, whose characteristics are most similar to those of the

treatment group before the treatment.

Second, SC's control group is always a combination of potential units so that in most cases its synthetic results are better than what they would be when the comparison group is equal to a single unit, as a neighboring country. SC presents explicitly what will make up the control group. The group will be a weighted average of the potential control units. Once this happens, we have made a best use of all the units, except the treatment unit in question, available to us, and chosen the optimal weights of each unit to compose the supposedly best control group.

We observe 161 countries and Cameroon is exposed to the treatment, that is, the economic crisis. So 160 remaining countries are candidates of the control group. Let Y_{it}^N be the outcome of life expectancy that would be observed for country i at time t in the absence of the crisis, for countries $i = 1, \dots, 161$, and time periods $t = 1980, 1981, \dots, 2005$. Because Cameroon's economic downturn started in 1987, the number of pretreatment periods is 7 and that of posttreatment ones is 19. Let Y_{it}^I be the outcome of life expectancy that would be observed for country i at time t after 1987. If we assume the countries other than Cameroon did not experience similar economic crises after 1987, then we should have that $Y_{it}^I = Y_{it}^N$ where i denotes a country from the control group. Let $\alpha_{it} = Y_{it}^I - Y_{it}^N$ be the treatment effect of the economic crisis on life expectancy for country i at time t , and let D_{it} be an indicator that is equal to 1 if country i is supposed to receive the treatment of crisis at time t , and 0 otherwise. The observed outcome for country i at time t is $Y_{it} = Y_{it}^N + \alpha_{it} D_{it}$. According to our data, $i = 1$ represents Cameroon so we try to estimate α_{1t} . And because Y_{1t}^I is observed, we just need to predict Y_{1t}^N . Suppose that Y_{it}^N is given by a factor model $Y_{it}^N = \delta_t + \theta_t X_i + \gamma_t \mu_i + \varepsilon_{it}$, where δ_t is an unknown common factor with constant factor loadings across countries, and the vector X_i includes various control variables, μ_i measures country i 's fixed effect. As for the construction of the control group, synthetic Cameroon should be a particular weighted average of countries other than Cameroon. The value of Y_{1t}^N is $\sum_{i=2}^{161} \omega_i Y_{it} = \delta_t + \theta_t \sum_{i=2}^{161} \omega_i X_i + \gamma_t \sum_{i=2}^{161} \omega_i \mu_i + \sum_{i=2}^{161} \omega_i \varepsilon_{it}$. So we have that $\widehat{\alpha}_{1t} = Y_{1t}^I - \sum_{i=2}^{161} \omega_i Y_{it}$. As we have said, we will choose the optimal weights of each country to make the comparison group resemble real Cameroon before the economic crisis the most. Thus we will find out the optimal weights, a vector of ω_i^* by applying SC procedure. Its goal is to figure out the minimum of mean squared prediction error (MSPE) during the pretreatment, whose value is $MSPE_{Pre} = \frac{1}{7} \sum_{t=1980}^{1986} (Y_{1t} - \sum_{i=2}^{161} \omega_i Y_{it})^2$. After that, we get the optimal weights of each country and thus the best control group, synthetic Cameroon.

Furthermore, placebo tests are indispensable. The tests are designed by Abadie and his collaborators. We will check the robustness after we get the basic outcomes. Our research will undergo some of them to make sure our results are reliable. Now we just skip the parts of introducing these tests.

As our focus is the effect of Cameroon's economic downturn on its life expectancy and we believe we have already shown some basic ideas of how SC works, we will not discuss more technical details of SC in the latter parts of this article, except the placebo tests. We include as many literatures that may demonstrate these details to readers in the references as possible, though.

Finally, we will illustrate the gap between actual life expectancy in Cameroon and what it would have been in the absence of the economic crisis, by applying the data-driven method. How would life expectancy have evolved in Cameroon after 1987 in the absence of the economic crisis? After we construct the synthetic Cameroon, the control group that most resembles Cameroon from 1980-1986 in terms of some critical characteristics such as GDP per capita and life expectancy, we will display the results in sequence.

Table 3.2 suggests that synthetic Cameroon is similar to that in the real world in terms of child mortality rate, real GDP per capita and life expectancy in 1980, 1982, 1984, respectively. For example, synthetic child mortality rate is just 0.04 percentage points lower than the real one. So we may infer that the comparison group fits in with real Cameroon before the treatment. Table 3.3 shows the weights of each remaining country in the synthetic Cameroon. The control group is mainly made up of Uganda, Iran and Cambodia.

As Table 3.4 and Figure 3.3 suggest, the gap in 1987 between real Cameroon and Synthetic Cameroon is very tiny, indicating that the economic downturn initially did not play a big role in the decline of life expectancy. But as time goes on, the gap is wider and wider. In 1992, Cameroon's life expectancy is estimated to be more than 1 year lower than it should have been in the absence of the economic crisis. Just 2 years later, it is more than 2 years lower than it should have been. After another 2 years, it is more than 3 years lower than it should have been. In 1998, it is more than 4 years lower than it should have been. And in the first five years of the new century, the gap is widening, not at a low speed still. We are surprised that in 2005, people are then expected to live almost 6 years shorter than they would do without facing the previous economic problems. Even if we do not go through the change of life expectancy in subsequent years, we may find that the effect of the economic crisis on average life span have lasted longer than the time the country has taken to get away from the trend of economic decline.

Table 3.2 The Similarity between Real Cameroon and Synthetic Cameroon

Variables	Cameroon	
	Real	Synthetic
Child Mortality Rate	16.01	15.97
Real GDP per Capita	3269.57	3754.66
Life Expectancy (1980)	51.21	51.29
Life Expectancy (1982)	51.96	52.02
Life Expectancy (1984)	52.52	52.58

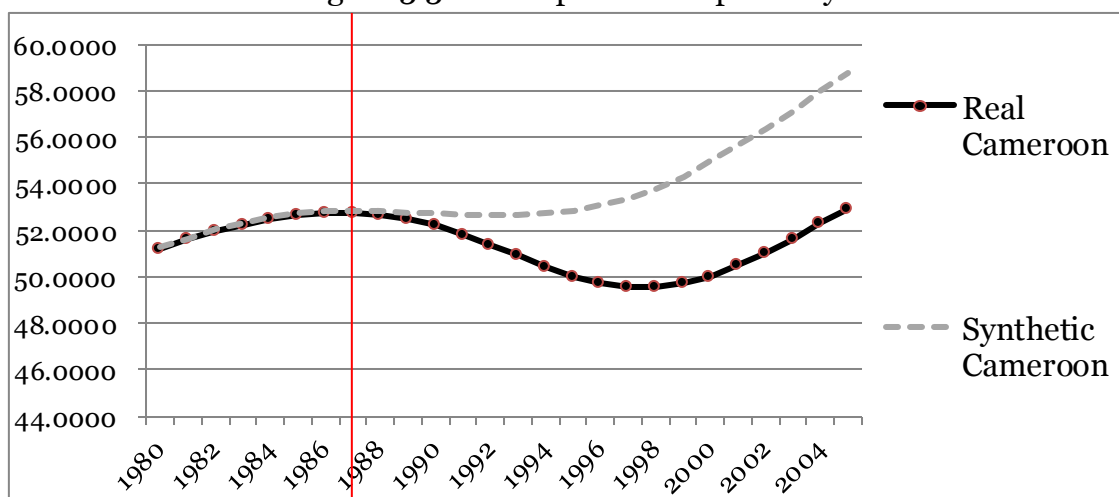
Table 3.3 Country Weights in the Synthetic Cameroon

Country	Weight	Country	Weight	Country	Weight	Country	Weight	Country	Weight
Albania	0.002	Costa Rica	0.002	Indonesia	0.003	Montenegro	0.001	Seychelles	0.002
Azerbaijan	0.001	Cote d'Ivoire	0.002	Iran	0.081	Morocco	0.002	Sierra Leone	0.007
Afghanistan	0.001	Croatia	0.001	Iraq	0	Mozambique	0	Singapore	0.001
Algeria	0.001	Cuba	0.002	Ireland	0.001	Myanmar	0.01	Slovenia	0.001
Angola	0.01	Cyprus	0.001	Israel	0.001	Namibia	0.002	South Africa	0.001
Argentina	0.001	Czech Republic	0.001	Italy	0.001	Nepal	0.002	South Korea	0.002
Armenia	0.002	Democratic Republic of	0.002	Jamaica	0.002	Netherlands	0.001	Spain	0.001
Australia	0.001	Congo	0.001	Japan	0.001	New Zealand	0.001	Sri Lanka	0.003
Austria	0.001	Denmark	0.001	Jordan	0.002	Nicaragua	0.002	Sudan	0.004
Bahrain	0.001	Djibouti	0.004	Kazakhstan	0.001	Niger	0.039	Swaziland	0.003
Bangladesh	0.002	Dominican Republic	0.002	Kenya	0.004	Nigeria	0.003	Sweden	0.001
Barbados	0.002	Ecuador	0.002	Kuwait	0.001	North Korea	0.006	Switzerland	0.001
Belarus	0.002	Egypt	0.002	Kyrgyzstan	0.002	Norway	0.001	Syria	0.002
Belgium	0.001	El Salvador	0.002	Laos	0.003	Oman	0.001	Tajikistan	0.002
Benin	0.002	Equatorial Guinea	0.002	Latvia	0.002	Pakistan	0.002	Tanzania	0.004
Bolivia	0.002	Estonia	0.002	Lebanon	0.002	Palestine	0.004	Thailand	0.003
Bosnia and Herzegovina	0.002	Ethiopia	0	Lesotho	0.009	Panama	0.002	Togo	0.003
Botswana	0.003	Finland	0.001	Liberia	0.003	Paraguay	0.002	Trinidad and Tobago	0.002
Brazil	0.002	France	0.001	Libya	0.001	Peru	0.002	Tunisia	0.002
Bulgaria	0.002	Gabon	0.001	Lithuania	0.001	Philippines	0.003	Turkey	0.002
Burkina Faso	0.002	Gambia	0.002	Luxembourg	0.001	Poland	0.002	Turkmenistan	0.002
Burundi	0.003	Georgia	0.001	Macedonia	0.001	Portugal	0.001	Uganda	0.461
Cambodia	0.058	Germany	0.001	Madagascar	0.006	Puerto Rico	0.001	Ukraine	0.001
Canada	0.001	Ghana	0.005	Malawi	0.003	Qatar	0	United Kingdom	0.001
Cape Verde	0.005	Greece	0.001	Malaysia	0.002	Romania	0.002	United States	0.001
Central African Republic	0.004	Guatemala	0.002	Mali	0.007	Russia	0.001	Uruguay	0.002
Chad	0.002	Guinea	0.003	Malta	0.001	Rwanda	0.004	Uzbekistan	0.002
Chile	0.002	Guinea-Bissau	0.003	Mauritania	0.003	Saint Lucia	0.002	Venezuela	0.001
China	0.003	Haiti	0.003	Mauritius	0.003	Sao Tome and Principe	0.004	Vietnam	0.003
Colombia	0.002	Honduras	0.001	Mexico	0.001	Saudi Arabia	0.001	Yemen	0.002
Comoros	0.004	Hungary	0.001	Moldova	0.003	Senegal	0.002	Zambia	0.025
Congo	0.002	Iceland	0.001	Mongolia	0.002	Serbia	0.001	Zimbabwe	0.004
		India	0.003						

Table 3.4 The Gap of Life Expectancy

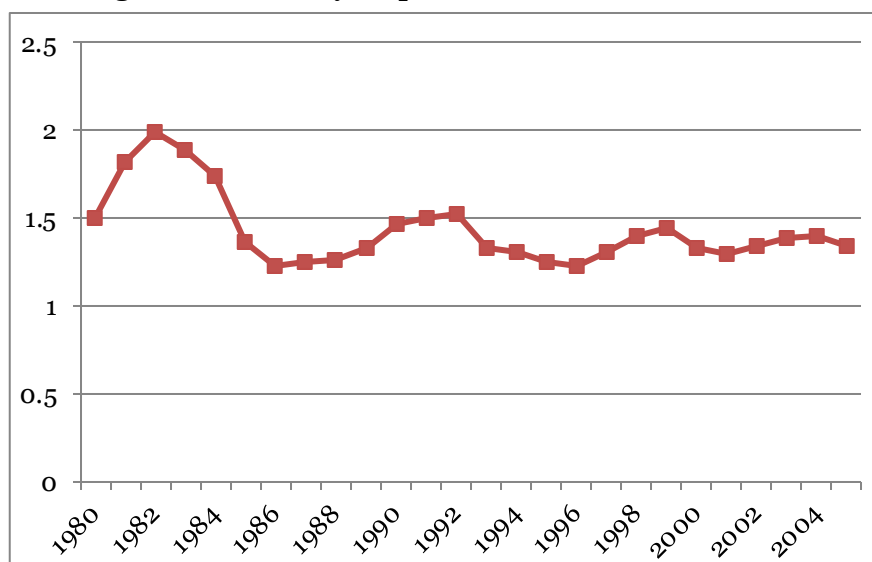
Year	Real Cameroon	Synthetic Cameroon	Gap
1980	51.2110	51.2854	-0.0744
1981	51.6040	51.6621	-0.0581
1982	51.9580	52.0240	-0.0660
1983	52.2660	52.3344	-0.0684
1984	52.5180	52.5760	-0.0580
1985	52.6980	52.7354	-0.0374
1986	52.7870	52.8132	-0.0262
1987	52.7810	52.8319	-0.0509
1988	52.6800	52.8151	-0.1351
1989	52.4900	52.7794	-0.2894
1990	52.2090	52.7359	-0.5269
1991	51.8350	52.6934	-0.8584
1992	51.3900	52.6633	-1.2733
1993	50.9100	52.6628	-1.7528
1994	50.4330	52.7115	-2.2785
1995	50.0150	52.8346	-2.8196
1996	49.7080	53.0550	-3.3470
1997	49.5430	53.3783	-3.8353
1998	49.5380	53.8037	-4.2657
1999	49.7000	54.3292	-4.6292
2000	50.0260	54.9472	-4.9212
2001	50.4950	55.6463	-5.1513
2002	51.0590	56.4014	-5.3424
2003	51.6710	57.1858	-5.5148
2004	52.3010	57.9796	-5.6786
2005	52.9160	58.7651	-5.8491

Figure 3.3 The Gap of Life Expectancy



But our results need to be examined thoroughly. Before we check the robustness, we should address some concerns. As for the first concern, one may argue that the economic crisis of the country may be not the cause of the decreasing life quality and that perhaps blows from wars, big natural disasters or incurable epidemics have made both the economy and the life in the country worse and worse. However, after careful scrutiny, the argument is dubious at best. On one hand, we could not find any reliable reports suggesting that Cameroon has recently undergone big wars with neighboring countries, environmental catastrophes or fatal diseases. Although some passages believe that some unsuccessful insurrections have occurred there in the 1990s, their influences should be small. As is shown in Figure 3.4, the military expenditure share of GDP in Cameroon has remained relatively stable in the last decade of the last century. This means the Biya government, if venal and incompetent, could cope with the uproars at a low expense. So the failed insurrections themselves could just have temporary, tiny effects on people's life at most. On the other hand, some articles claim that the collapse of international oil market contributes a lot to the trade deficits during the economic downturn. And some other articles believe that the incompetent government brings about the misuse of public funds, which ruins the economy there. Anyway, there is no evidence showing that non-economic factors in the country have greatly pushed the life expectancy to go down after 1987.

Figure 3.4 Military Expenditure Share of GDP(%)

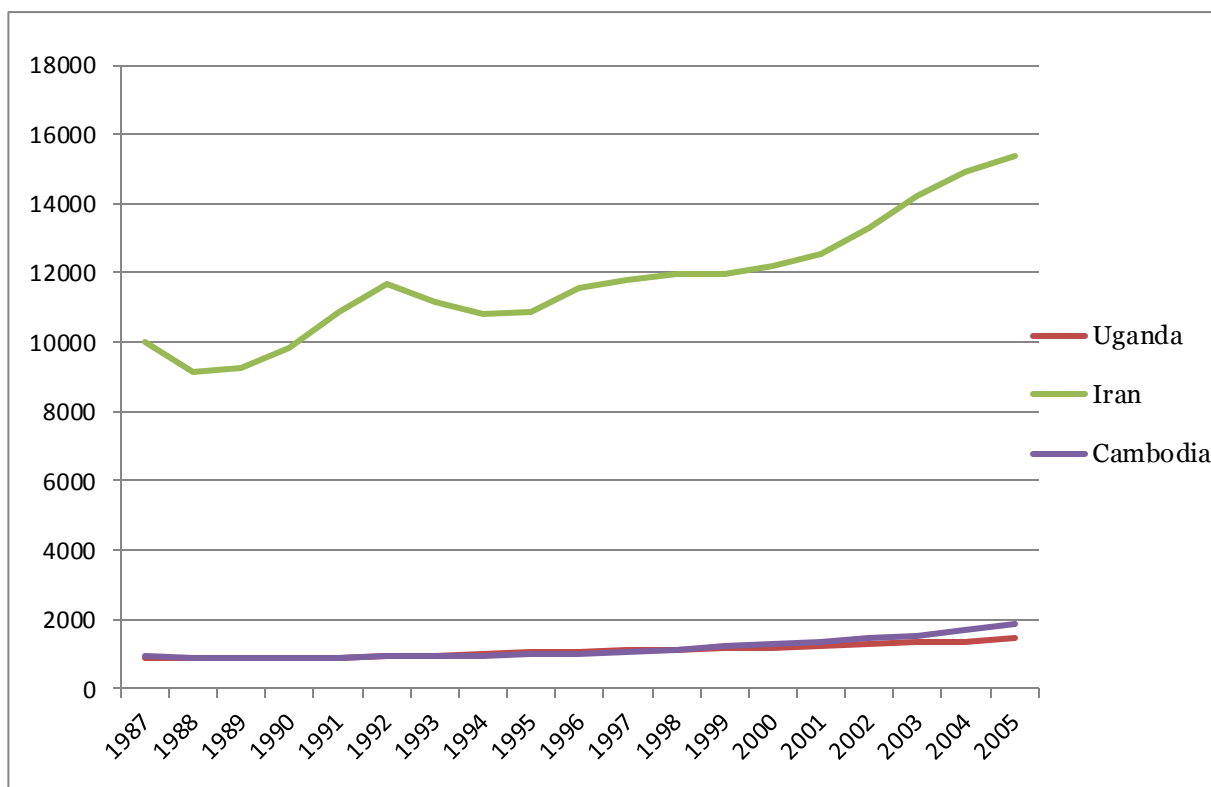


Another concern is that the economic hardship in Cameroon may affect the life quality of other countries in some ways, contaminating the control group. As we have shown, synthetic Cameroon is mainly made up of Uganda, Iran and Cambodia. But according to some literatures, the trading partners of the country are particularly France, Germany, and the United States, which contribute very little to the construction of the counterfactual group. Thus, the

major parts of the comparison group may not suffer from the recession of Cameroon itself very much, especially in terms of life expectancy. We may conclude that the economic downturn in Cameroon itself cannot lower living standards of other countries, especially of the major parts of synthetic Cameroon, regardless of some other factors that may influence the life expectancy of the two groups.

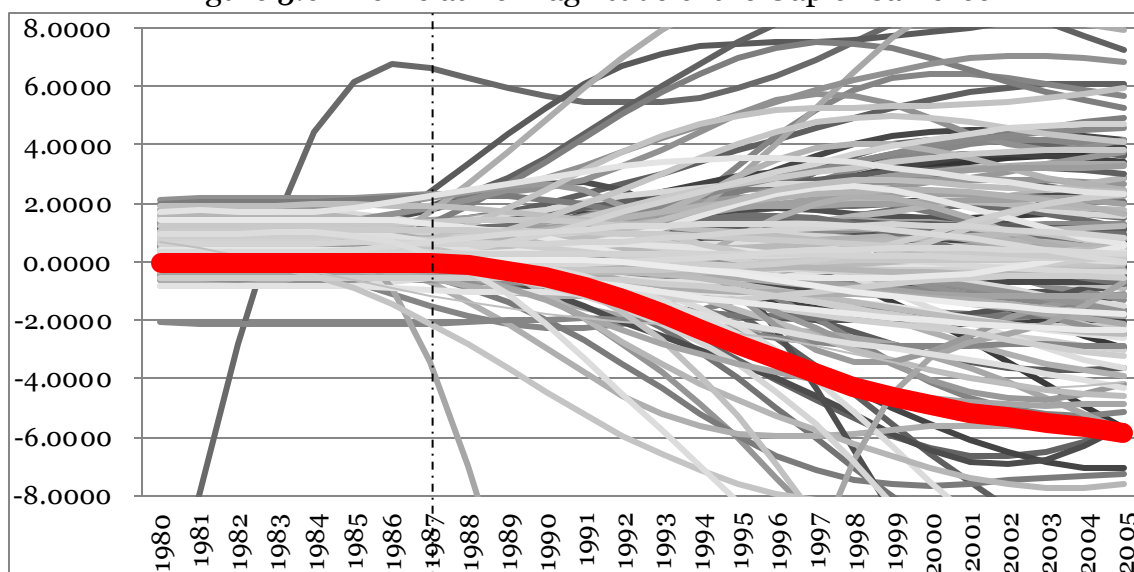
Furthermore, one would wonder whether countries in the control group have developed their economy poorly and suffered from the decrease in life span, the way Cameroon has done. If so, our estimates may be attenuated and biased because the life expectancy of each country other than Cameroon is also lower than what it should be in the absence of the recession. So should the gap between actual life expectancy in Cameroon and what it would otherwise have been become larger? It is true that we do not figure out how they have been affected by some common economic factors, such as the decline in oil price, during the period in question from 1980-2005. But at least the three countries have not displayed strong economic recession at that time. As Figure 3.5 suggests, during the posttreatment period, both the economy of Uganda and that of Cambodia have increased, if slowly. And Iran have experienced a relatively rapid economic growth at that time. So we can firmly state that the major parts of synthetic Cameroon have not received treatments similar to the economic crisis in Cameroon.

Figure 3.5 GDP per Capita of Major Parts of Synthetic Cameroon



Let us turn to discuss some placebo tests to check the robustness. Could our predictions of the gap in each year be driven by chance? Suppose that we perceive a country rather than Cameroon as one that have gone through the economic crisis the exactly same way Cameroon have done. Could we still get as wide a gap as the one above? these tests, put forward by Abadie and his collaborators, help us apply SC to every country to estimate the effect of the supposed crisis having taken place in that country since 1987 and see if the gap of Cameroon is considerably large relative to those of other countries.

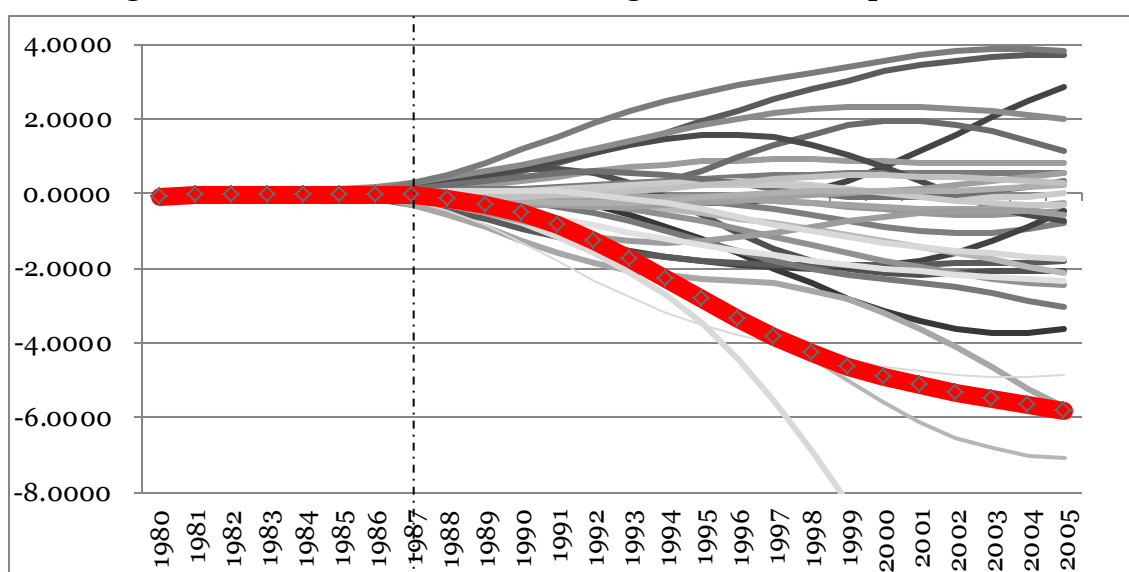
Figure 3.6 The Relative Magnitude of the Gap of Cameroon



As is shown in Figure 3.6, the red line represents the gap of Cameroon, which is considerably large, larger than those of other countries. But it seems that there are a few countries that are suggested to experience the big decline in life expectancy too. However, if the synthetic counterpart of a country other than Cameroon could not fit the life expectancy for the country in the years before 1987, we may interpret that much of its post-1987 gap between the real one and the synthetic counterpart is also artificially created by lack of fit, rather than by the effect of the supposed economic crisis. So we will exclude the countries that could not find a proper synthetic control group in the preceding placebo test, by setting a cutoff of pretreatment MSPE.

Now we will exclude all countries that have a pretreatment MSPE more than 0.01. There are only 32 countries left in the Figure 3.7. Again, the red line represents the gap of Cameroon. It can be easily seen that only 2 grey lines are below the red line, indicating that the negative effect of the economic crisis on Cameroon's life expectancy is the third lowest among the remaining countries. Because the other 31 countries are all control units, the probability of estimating a gap of the magnitude of the gap for Cameroon under a random permutation of the treatment in our data is 32 divided by 3, that is, about 9.38%. In other words, our estimates are significant at the 10 percent level.

Figure 3.7 The Revised Relative Magnitude of the Gap of Cameroon



All in all, our results indicate that there may exist causality between Cameroon's economic crisis and the decline in its life expectancy. The effects of the economic crisis on average life span have lasted longer than we may expect. Even by 2005, Cameroonian people may live about 5.85 years shorter than they are expected to live in the absence of the economic recession.

4. Conclusion

Cameroon, a country located in central and western Africa, seems to benefit very little from its abundant natural resources in its recent development. In the past few decades, Cameroon always has a very low GDP per capita, which has been less than one-fifth of the world average even after 2008. The severe economic crisis at the end of the last century may account for the present poor economic performance on the world stage. We examine the negative effects of the economic recession, specifically on life expectancy in the case study. The results suggest that there may exist a causality between the economic crisis and the decline in the life expectancy. 10 years after the recession began, even when the economy got out of the downward trend, Cameroonian people may live more than 3 years shorter than they would live in the absence of the economic crisis. 15 years after the recession began, Cameroonian people may live more than 5 years shorter than they would otherwise live. Actually, the effects of the economic crisis on average life span have lasted much longer. Our results are significant at the 10 percent level. Besides, we research other dimensions of the country, such as population, equality, work & life, health, education, environment & energy, etc. Our report aims at providing an overall picture of the development in Cameroon. At the same time, we further study potential causes and effects of the economic downturn from 1987-1994.

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